

Power Platform from the Perspective of a Business Central Developer



"Why are we (still) not using Power Platform (as much)?"





Eric “waldo” Wauters

Partner
Development Manager

eric.wauters@ifacto.be

Microsoft MVP, Business Applications
[@waldo1001](https://twitter.com/waldo1001)
<http://www.waldo.be>



Tine “tine” Starič

Software Architect
Companial

Tine.staric@companial.com

Microsoft MVP, Business Applications
@TineStaric
<https://tine.staric.net/>

Some challenges in the world of software development



Repeatability

Build Reusable Assets

One-Time Effort, Many Sales

Scalable Delivery

- Fast, efficient

Maintainability

- Automated Upgrades
- Hotfixes

Standardized foundation

- BC & PP Platform

Maximize ROI

Maintainability

Automation

- CI/CD
- Validation
- Upgrades

Environment Accessibility (GDAP)

Product feedback

- Telemetry



Customization

Customers are never 100% happy with an out-of-the-box product.

- They have "unique" processes
- Improve efficiency
- Meet their industry needs
- Enhance user experience
- ...

Business Central in a nutshell

What is Business Central?

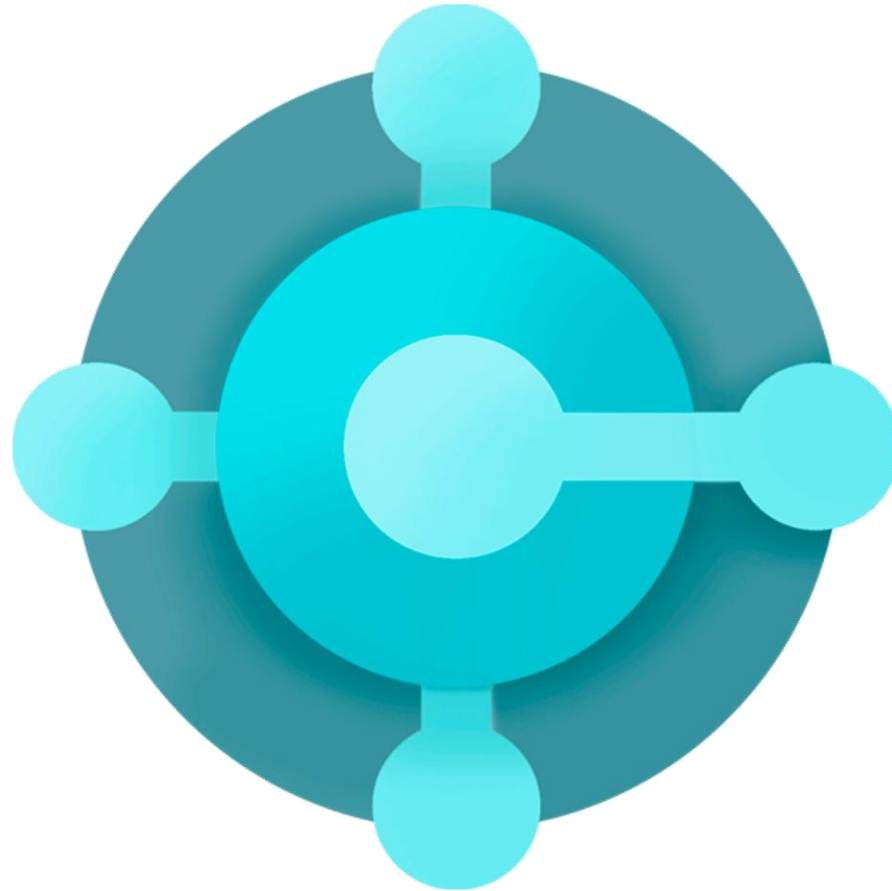
*Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central is a **cloud-based, all-in-one ERP** (Enterprise Resource Planning) solution designed for **small to medium-sized businesses***

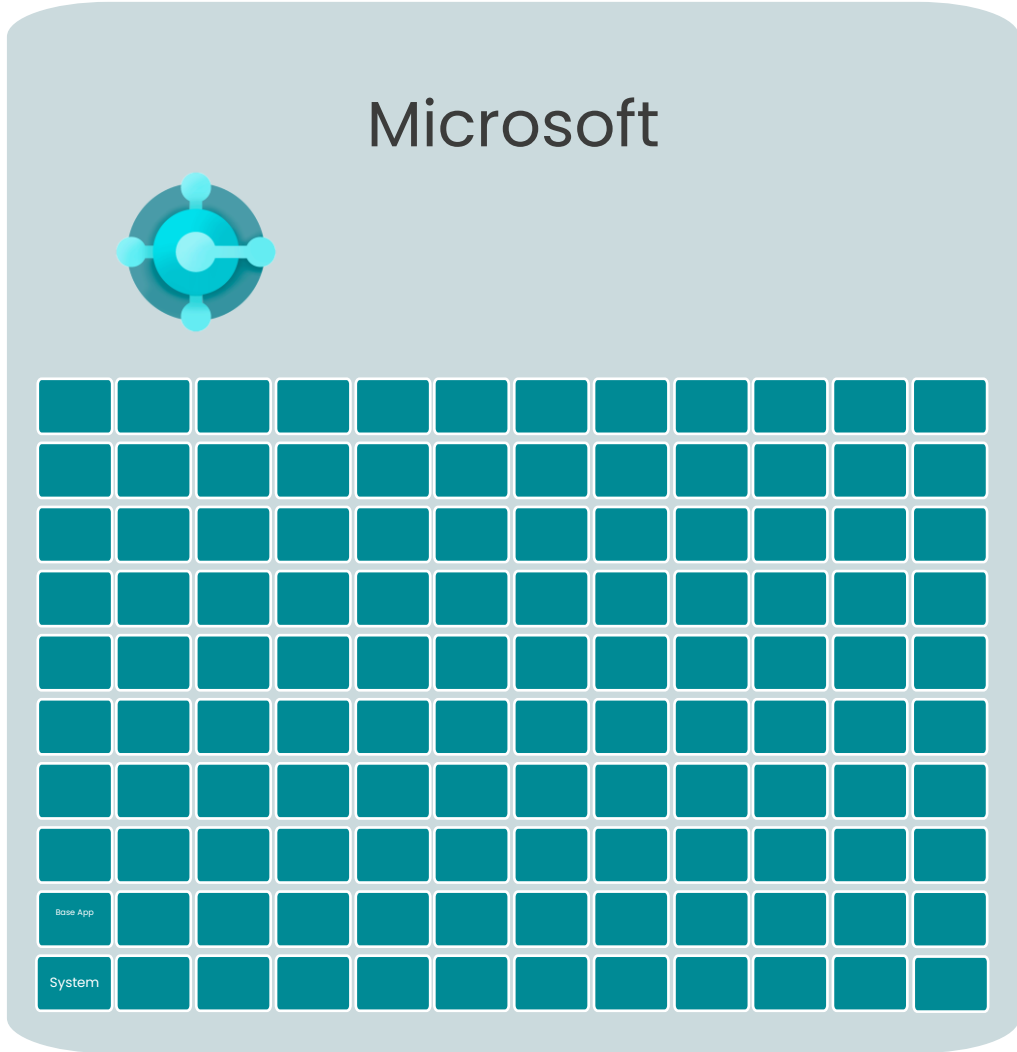
*Its **purpose** is to streamlines operations—finance, sales, inventory, purchasing, and more—in a single platform.*

*It is built on **modular** architecture and is highly **customizable** and **extensible**.*

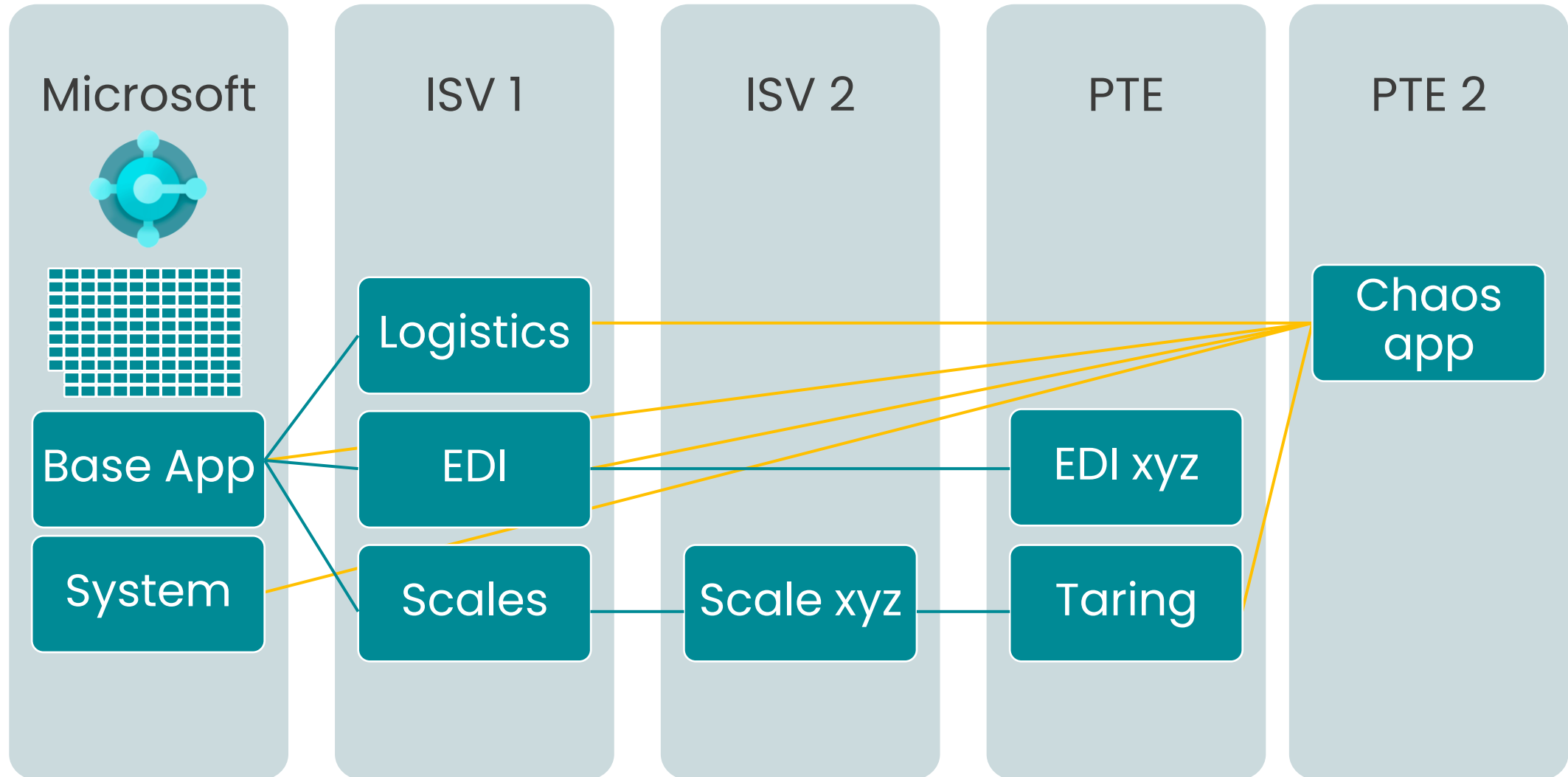
What is Business Central?

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Extensibility



Development Methodology

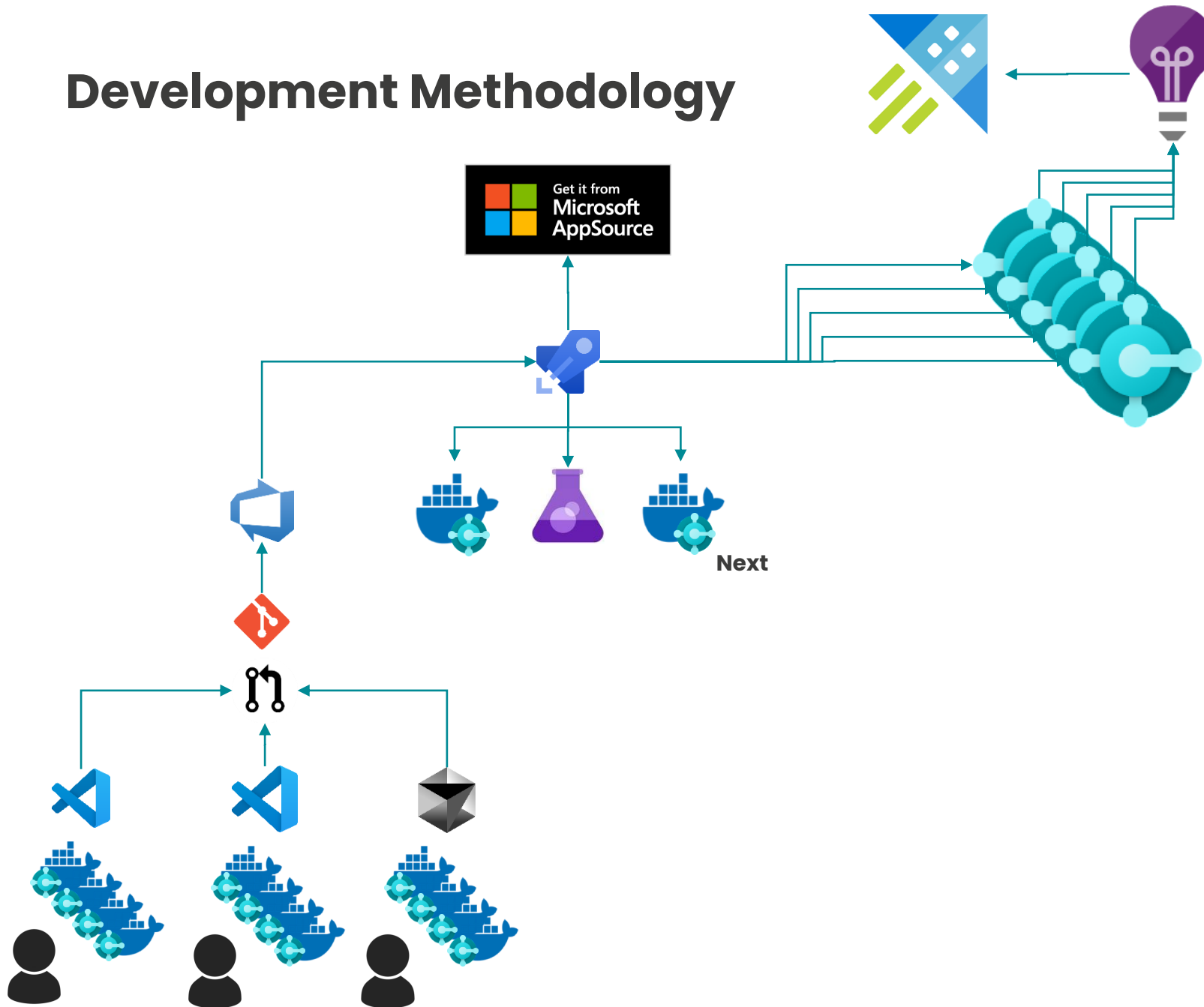


Development Methodology

Production



Development Methodology





Power Platform

Disclaimer



We could be completely wrong – but this is the world of PP from the eyes of a BC developer..

What is the Power Platform?

*A **low-code platform** to build **apps**, automate **workflows**, analyze **data**, and **integrate systems***

What is the Power Platform?

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Microsoft Power Platform

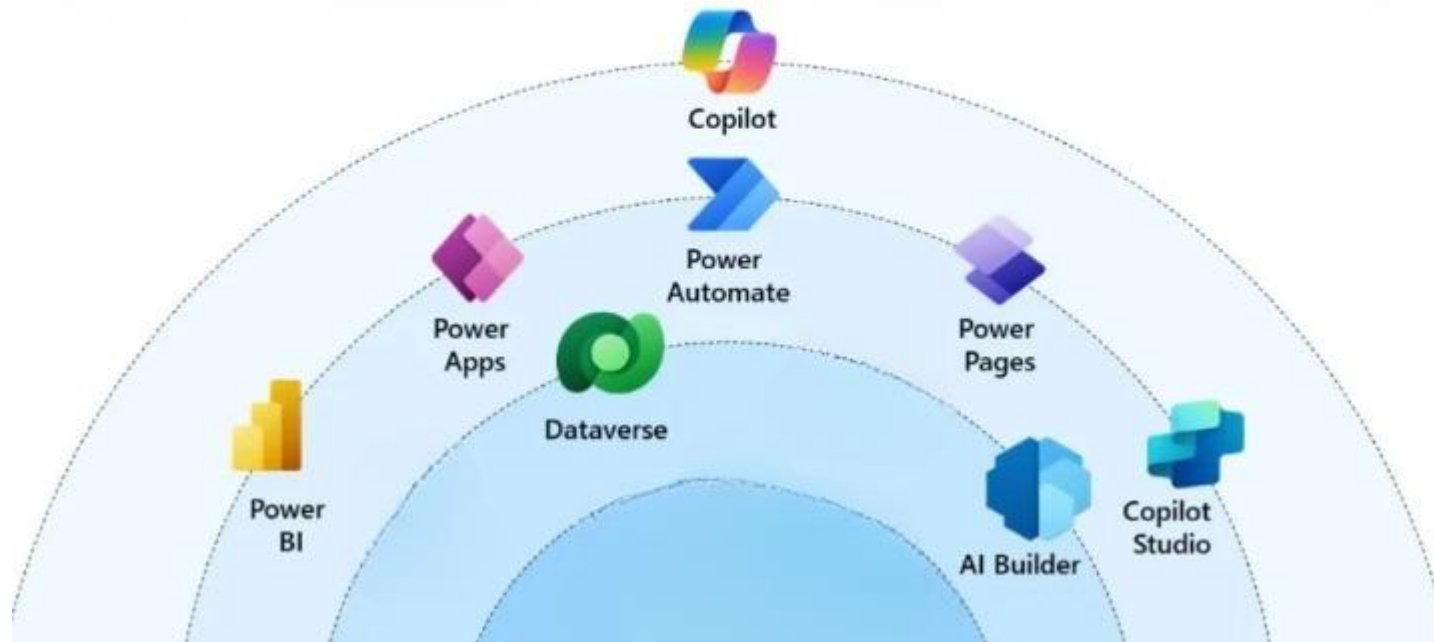
The world's **most complete** platform for developer productivity, spanning no-code to pro code



What is the Power Platform?

Microsoft Power Platform

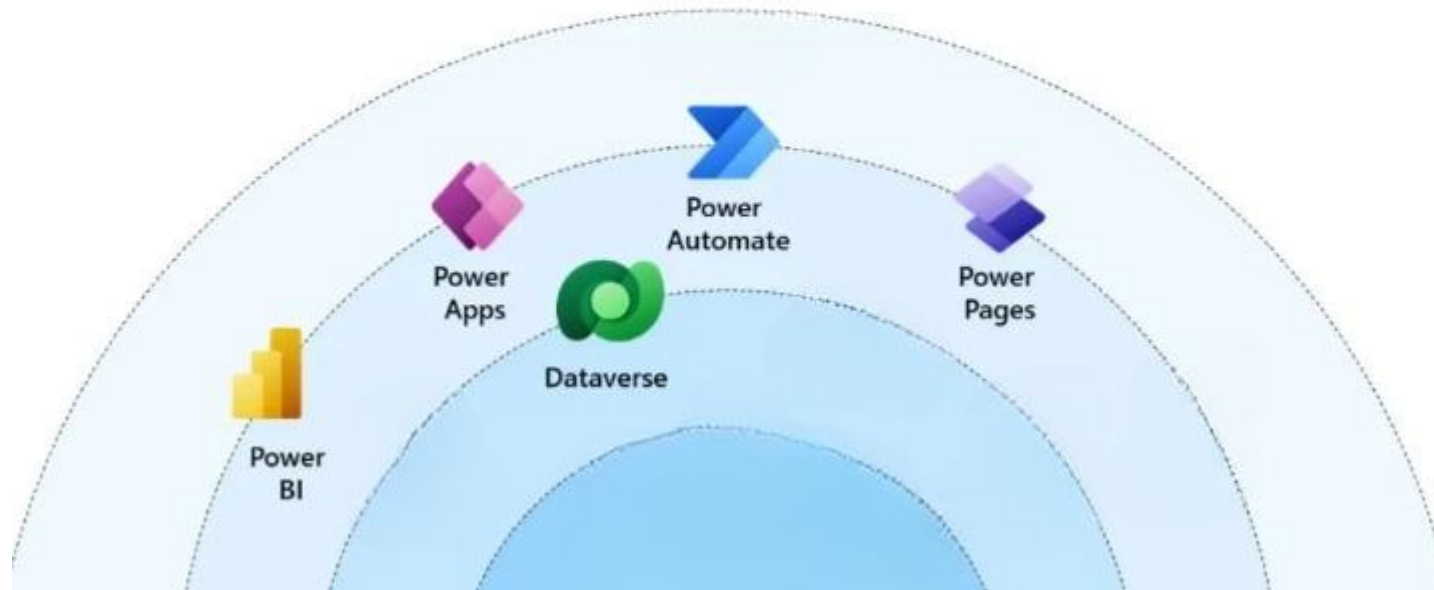
The world's **most complete** platform for developer productivity, spanning no-code to pro code



What is the Power Platform?

Microsoft Power Platform

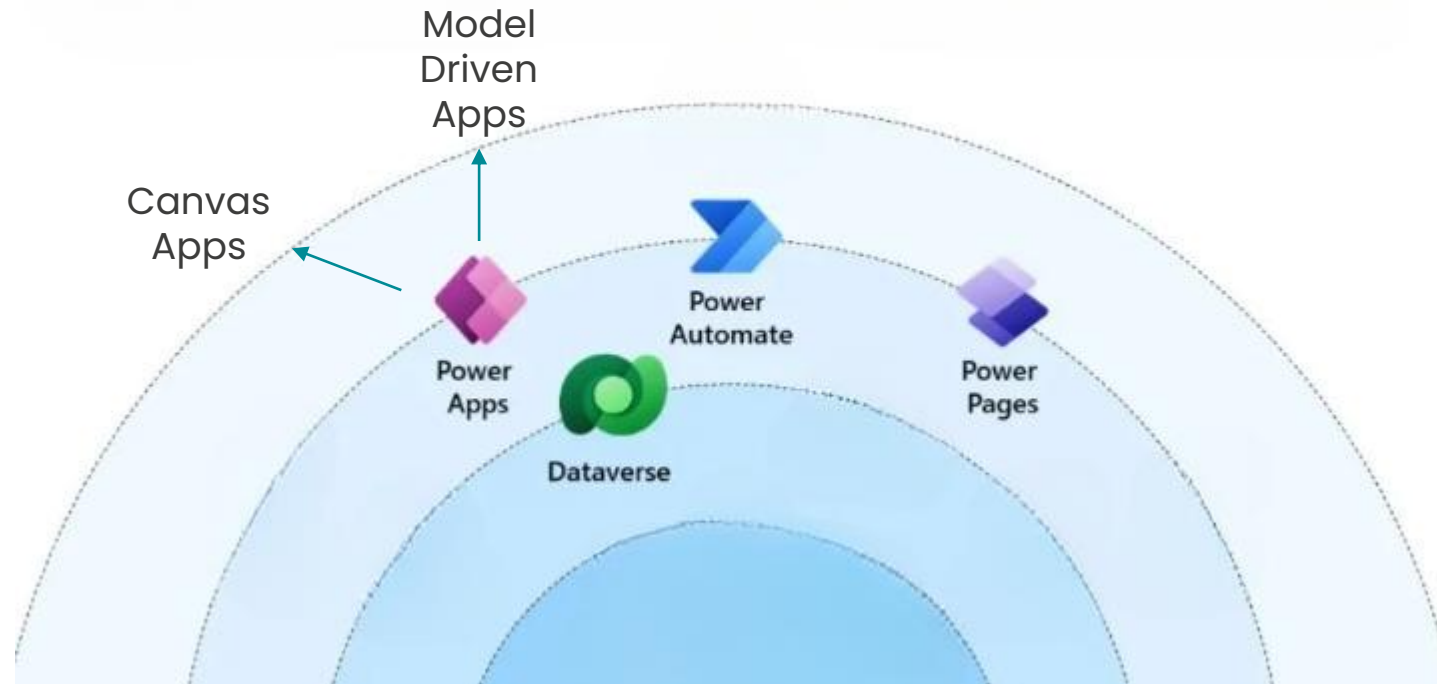
The world's **most complete** platform for developer productivity, spanning no-code to pro code



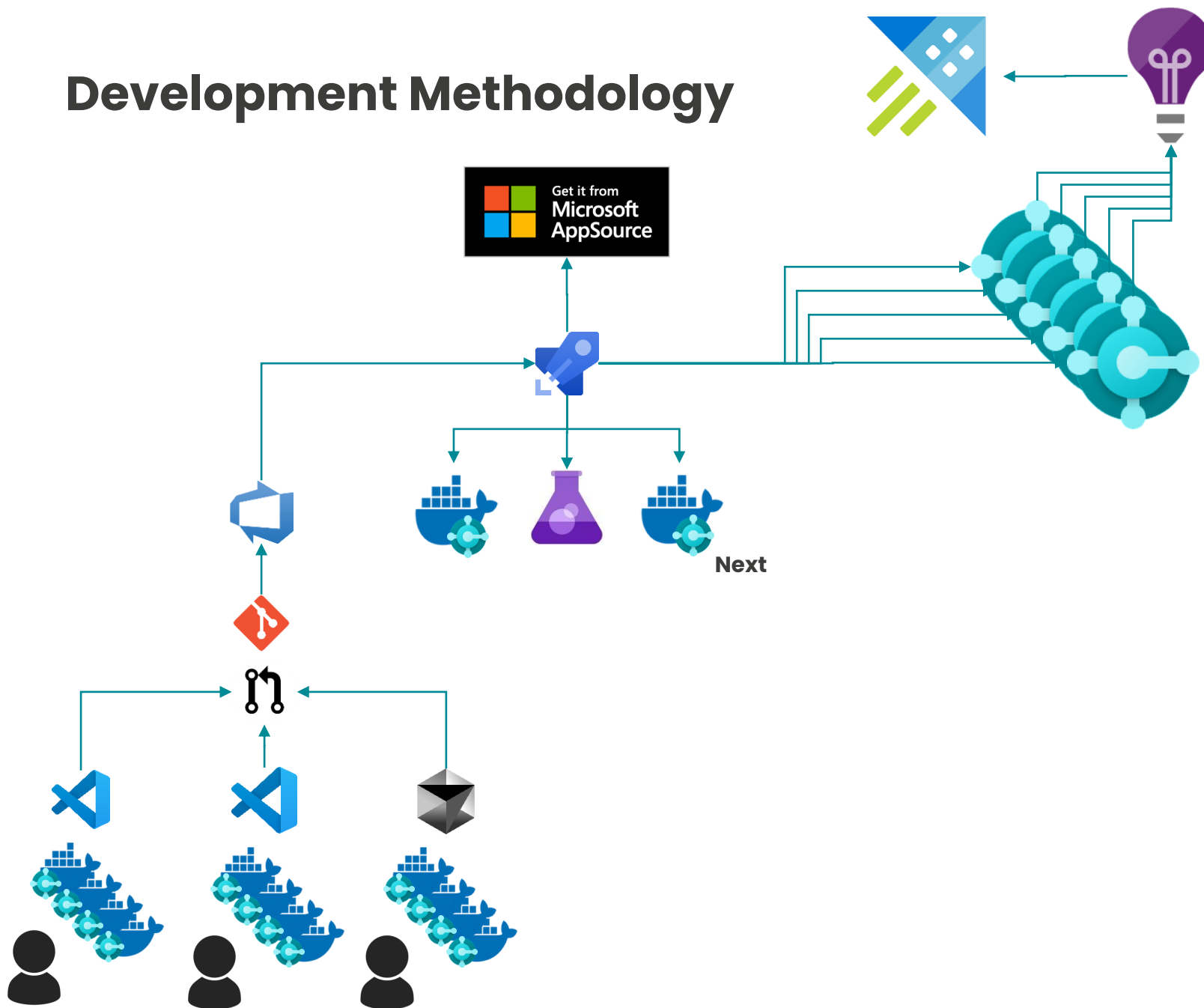
What is the Power Platform?

Microsoft Power Platform

The world's **most complete** platform for developer productivity, spanning no-code to pro code

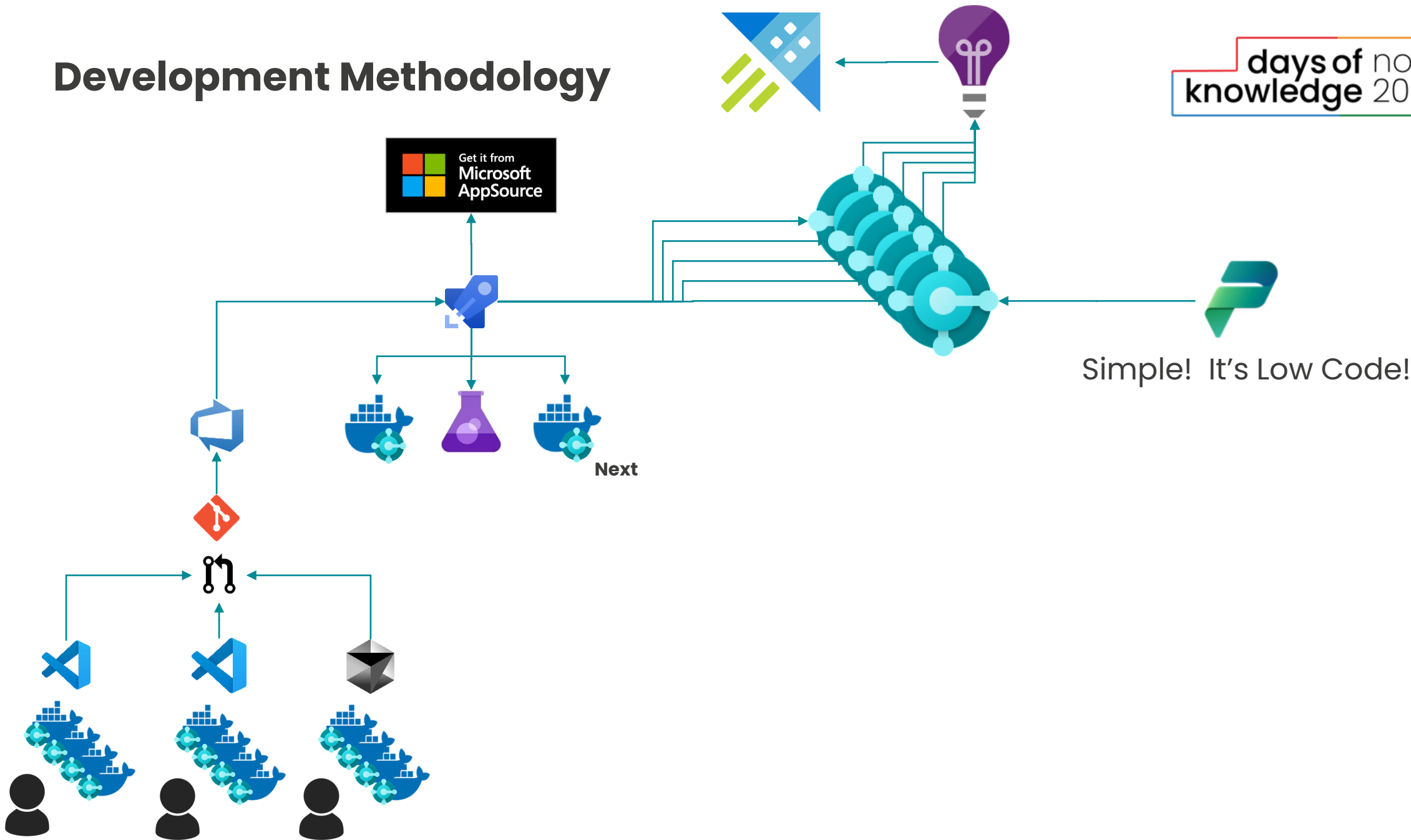


Development Methodology



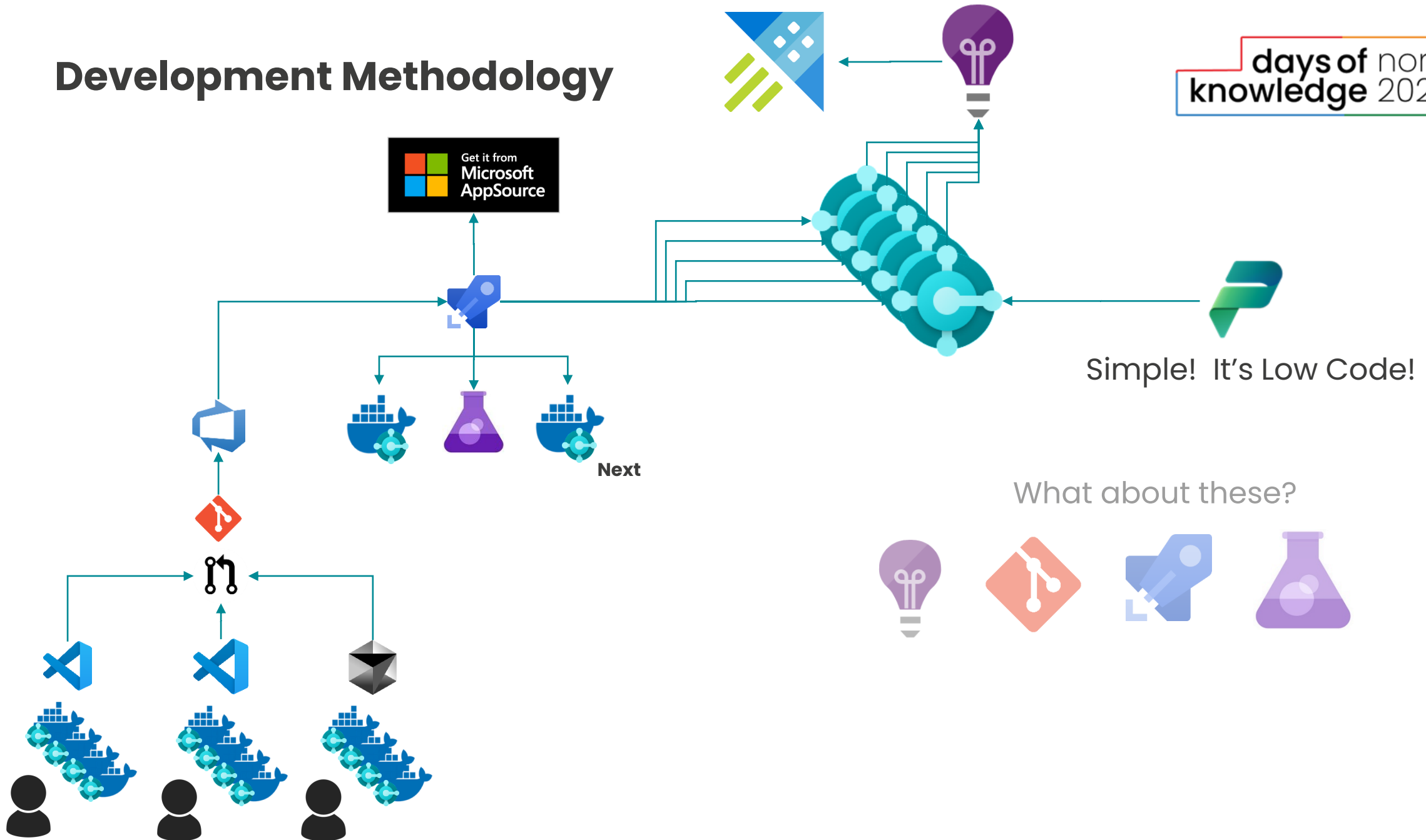
Development Methodology

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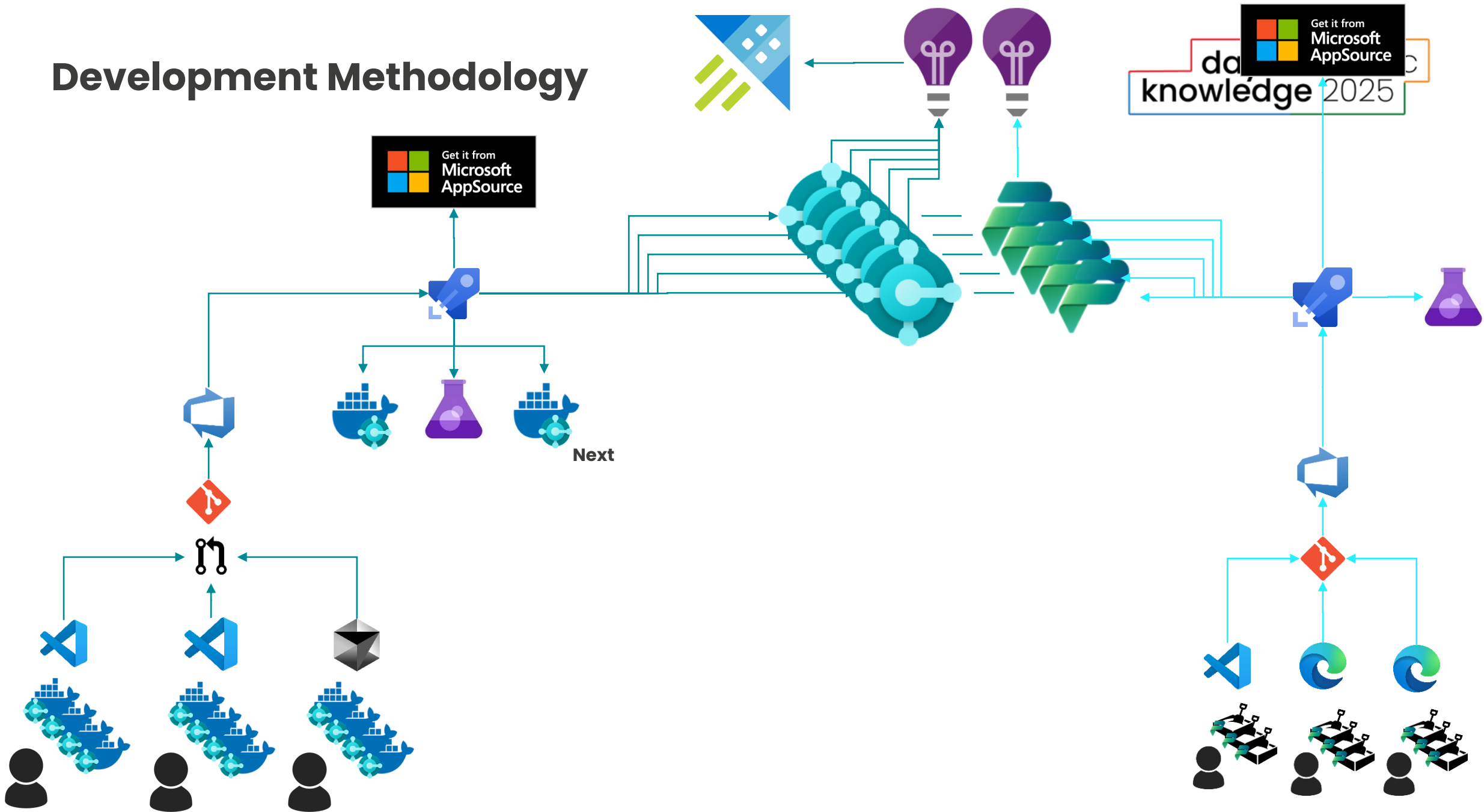


Development Methodology

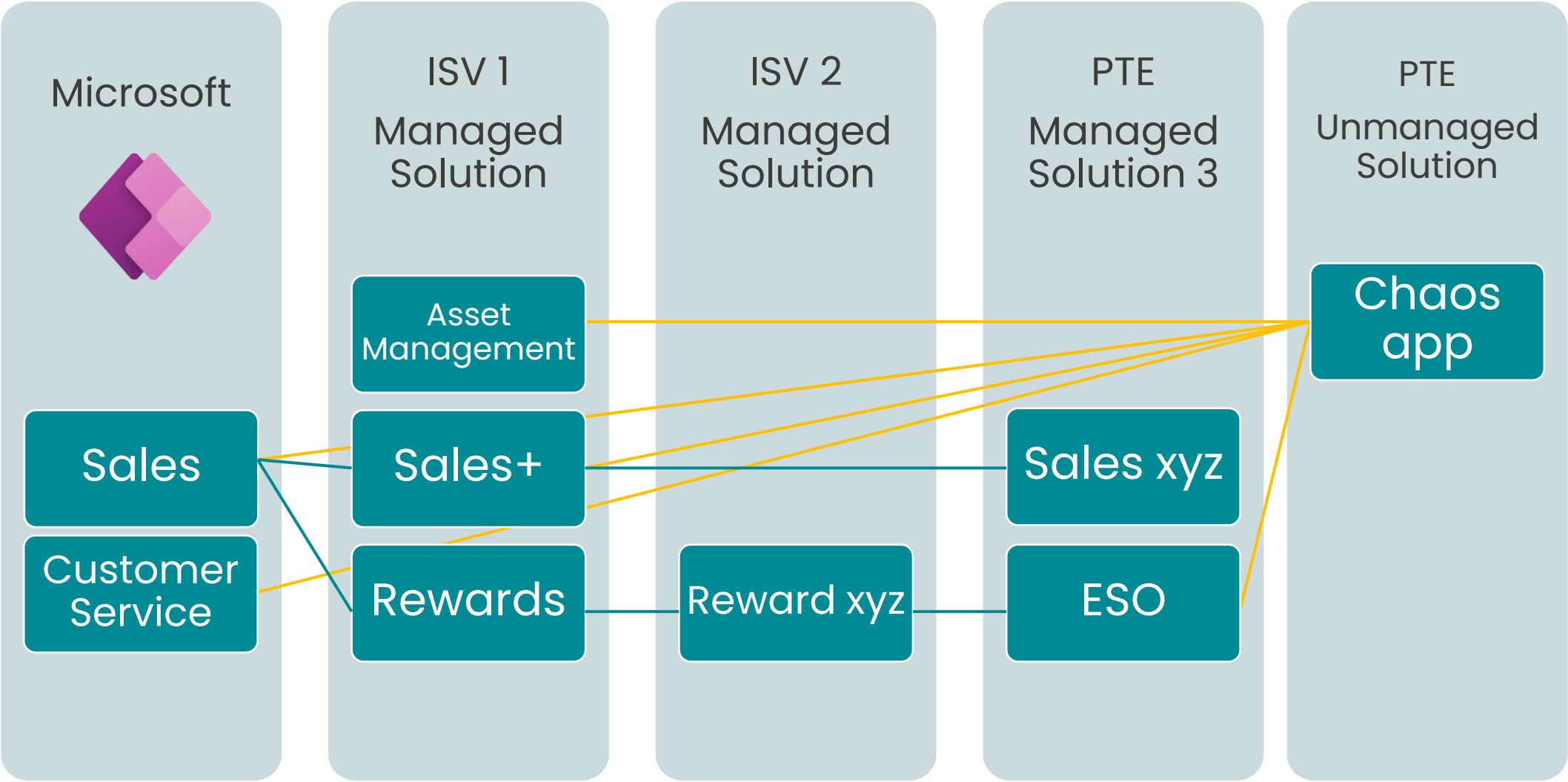
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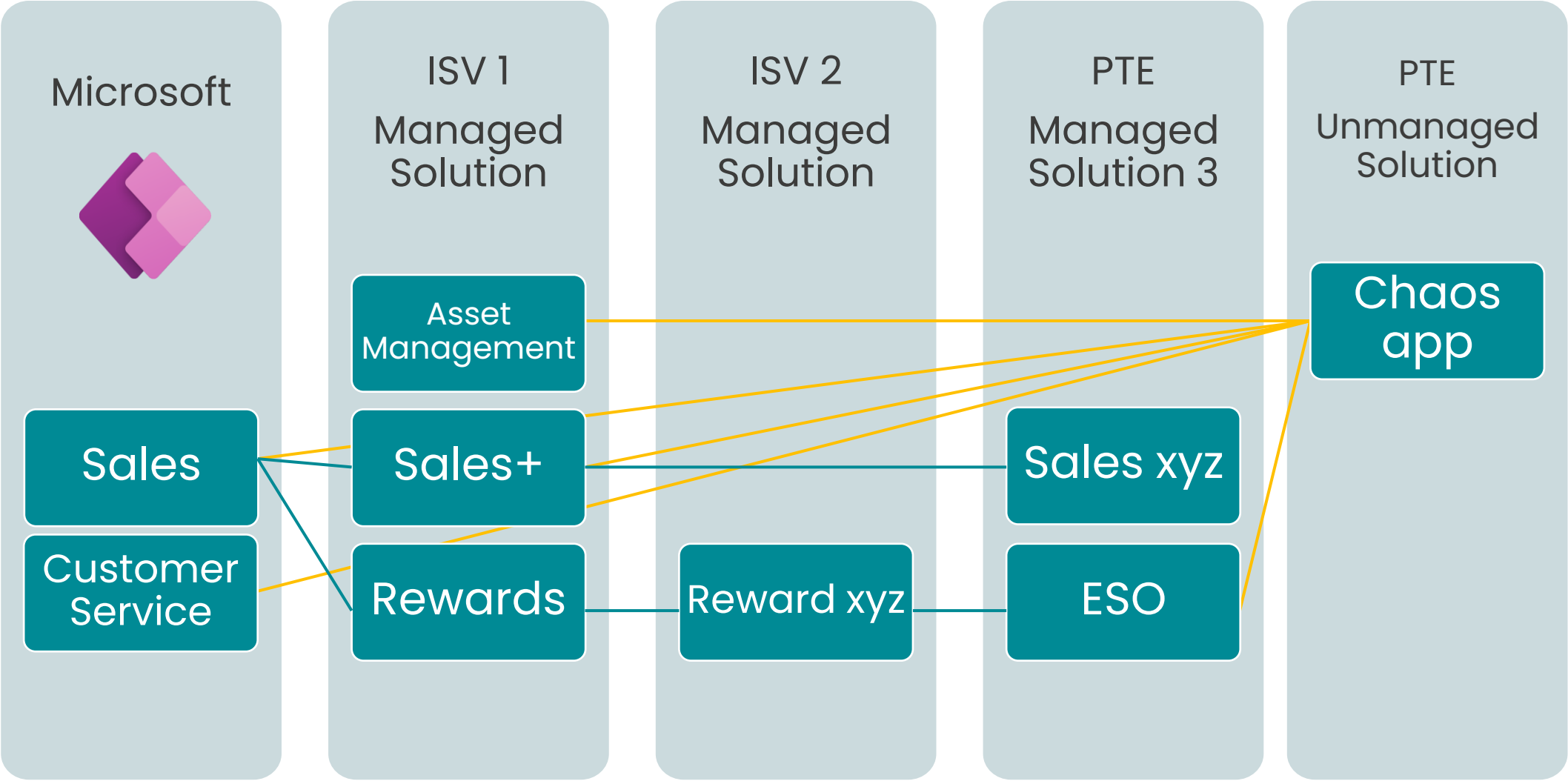
Development Methodology



Extensibility



Extensibility



Extensibility



Chaos
app

Extensibility



Canvas
app

Citizen Developer

What?

Non-professional dev

Typically a business user

Typically outside traditional dev teams

Low Code/No Code solutions



Citizen Developer

"I've built a very complex set of Power Automate flows that became the backbone of our Sales department.

When I left, it all fell apart"
-Tine Starič

Could work in Enterprise

Just doesn't work in SMB

When you combine PP with BC...

Deployment

You can't combine the installation of both apps

- Either BC first, but what if Power Platform fails?
- Or PP first, but what if BC fails?

Rollback

BC: not possible to install previous version.

PP: IS possible to roll back

Extensibility

Business Central:

Extensibility platform

Power Platform:

PTE apps in Power Platform don't exist.

Layer Merging does exist for Model Drive Apps.

Canvas Apps: no extensibility.

Conclusion: PP has an extensibility story, but not from how we use and see it.

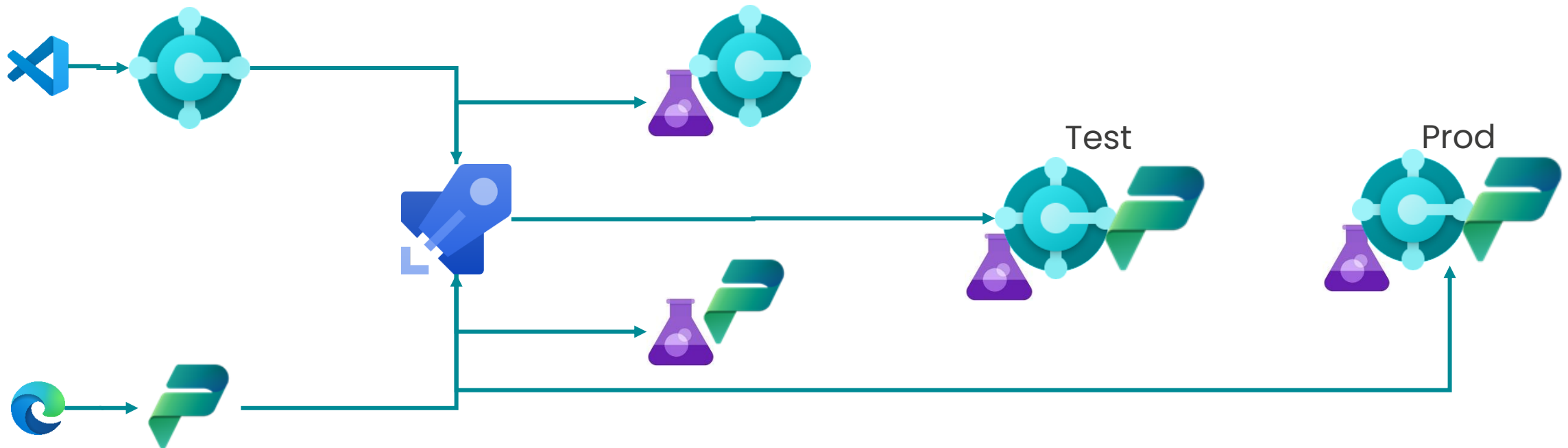
Validation

No automated validation/tests possible.

Now just imagine the monthly updates..

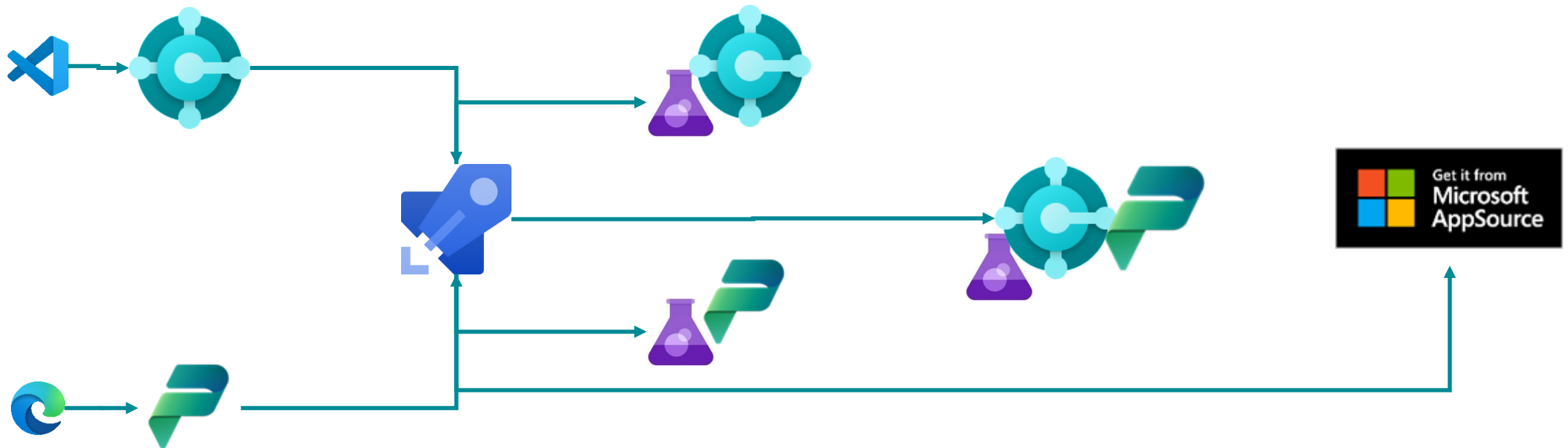
What do we do? – Deployment & Validation

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What do we do? – Deployment & Validation

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No one should modify any system at all except through a pipeline. You cannot test that a person will do it correctly, so don't let a person do it.



What do we do? – Extensibility

We do not clone apps

Customizations are application features

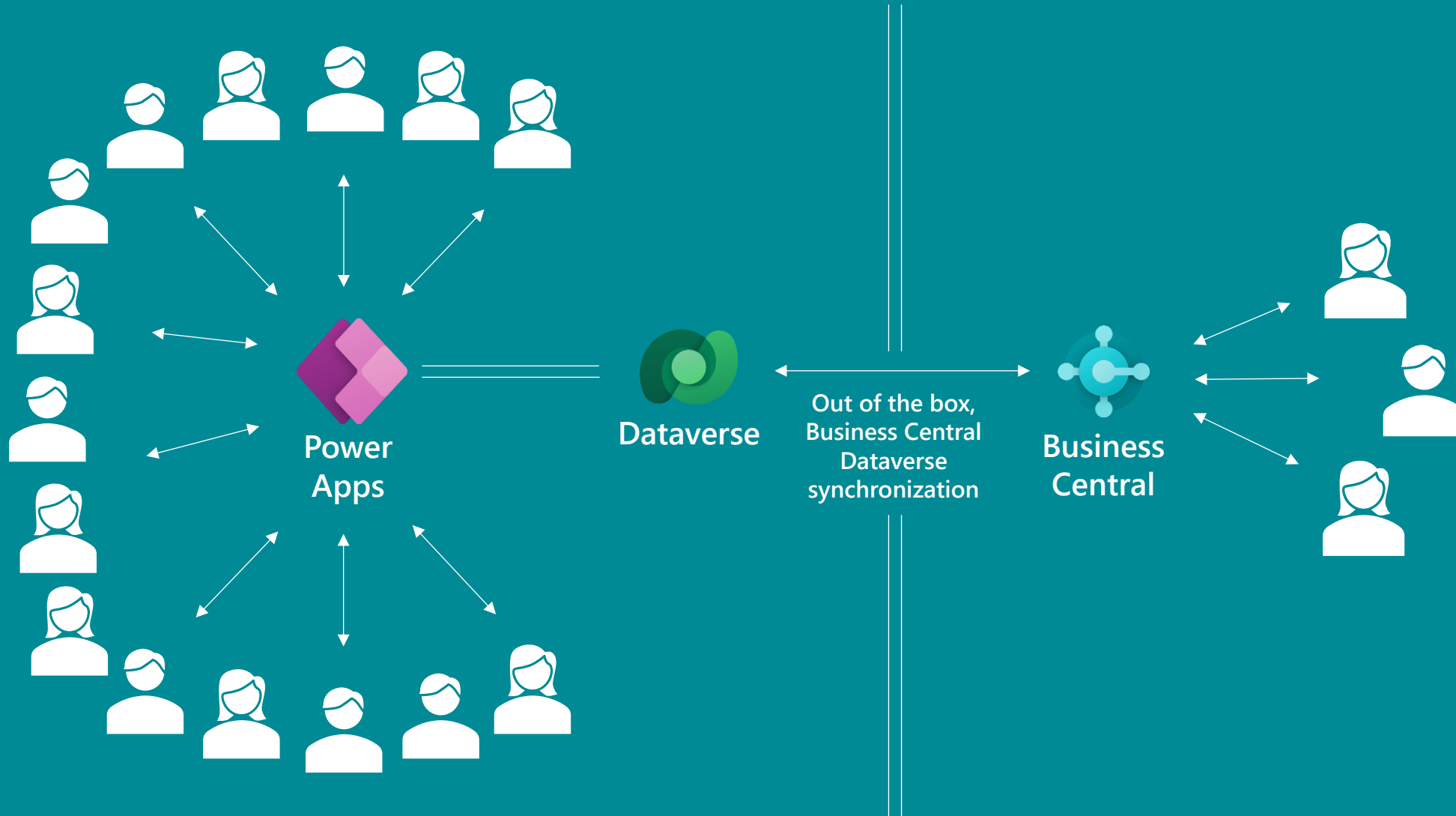


Licensing differences

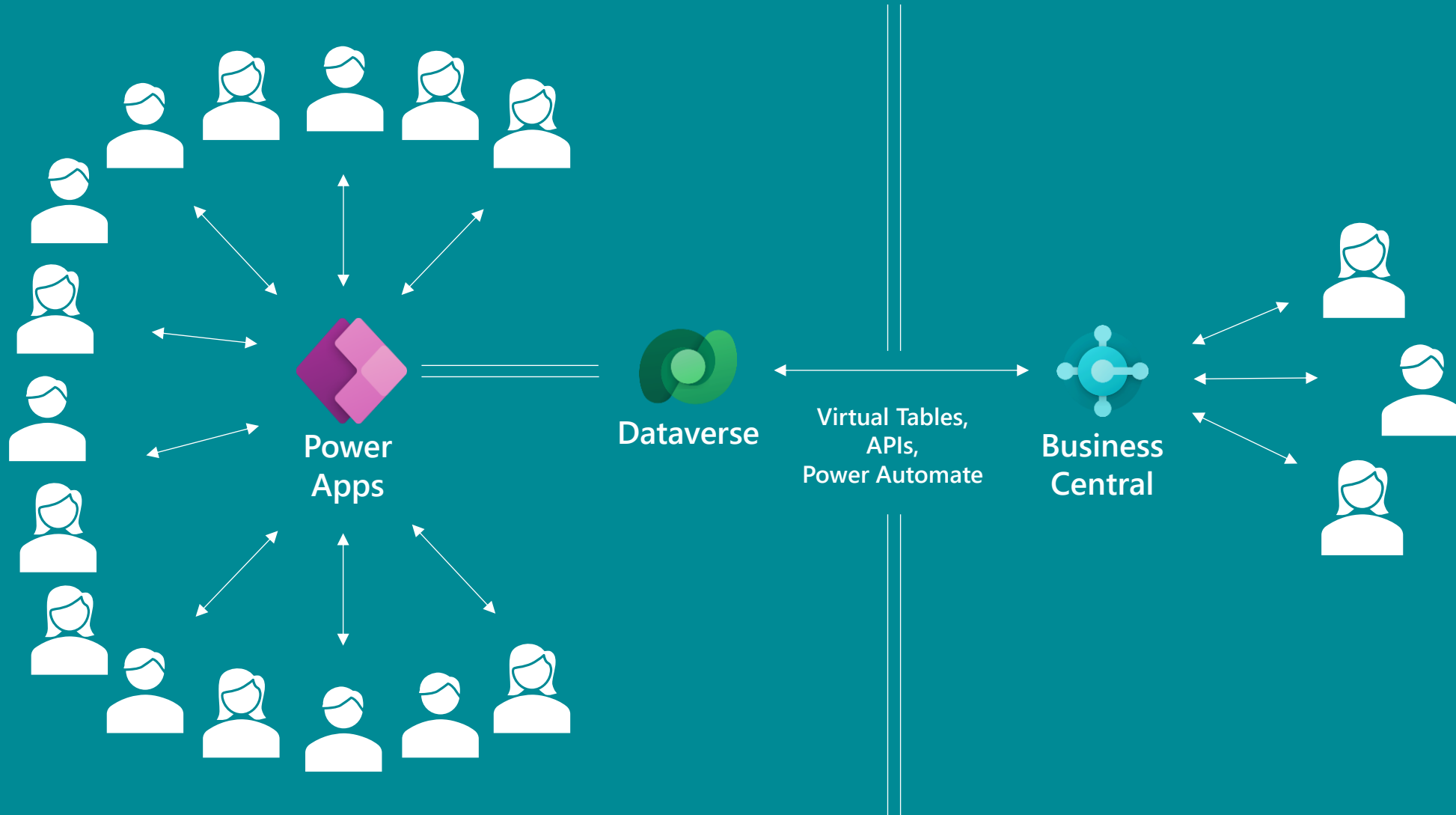
Multiplexing

The use of hardware or software to pool connections, reroute or indirectly access information, and/or reduce the number of devices or users that directly (or indirectly) access or use a product.

Multiplexing

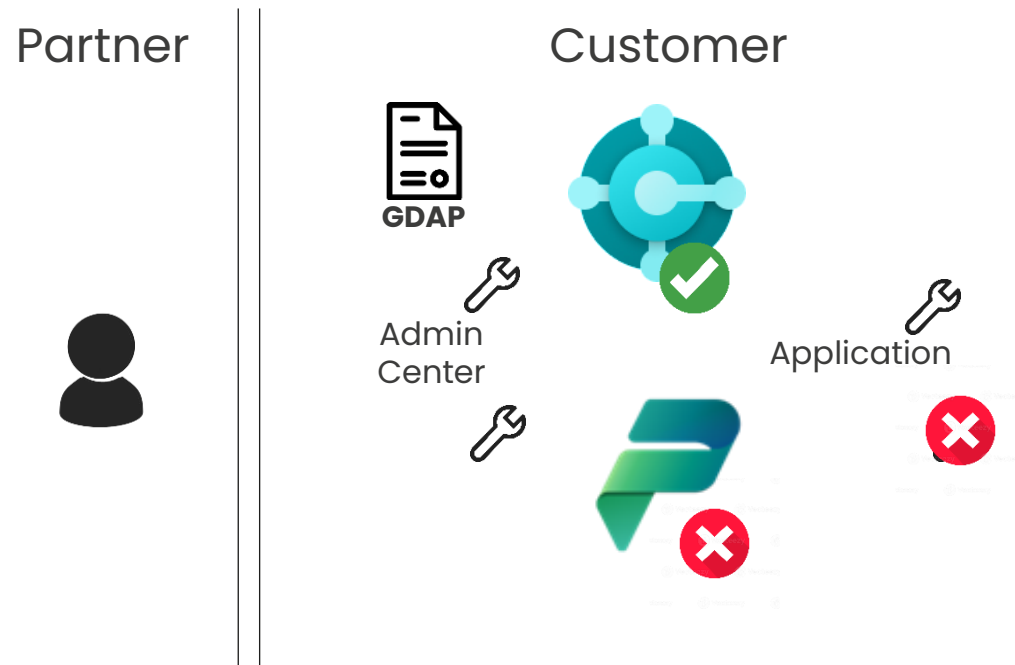


Multiplexing



Licensing differences

GDAP – Granular Delegated Admin Permissions

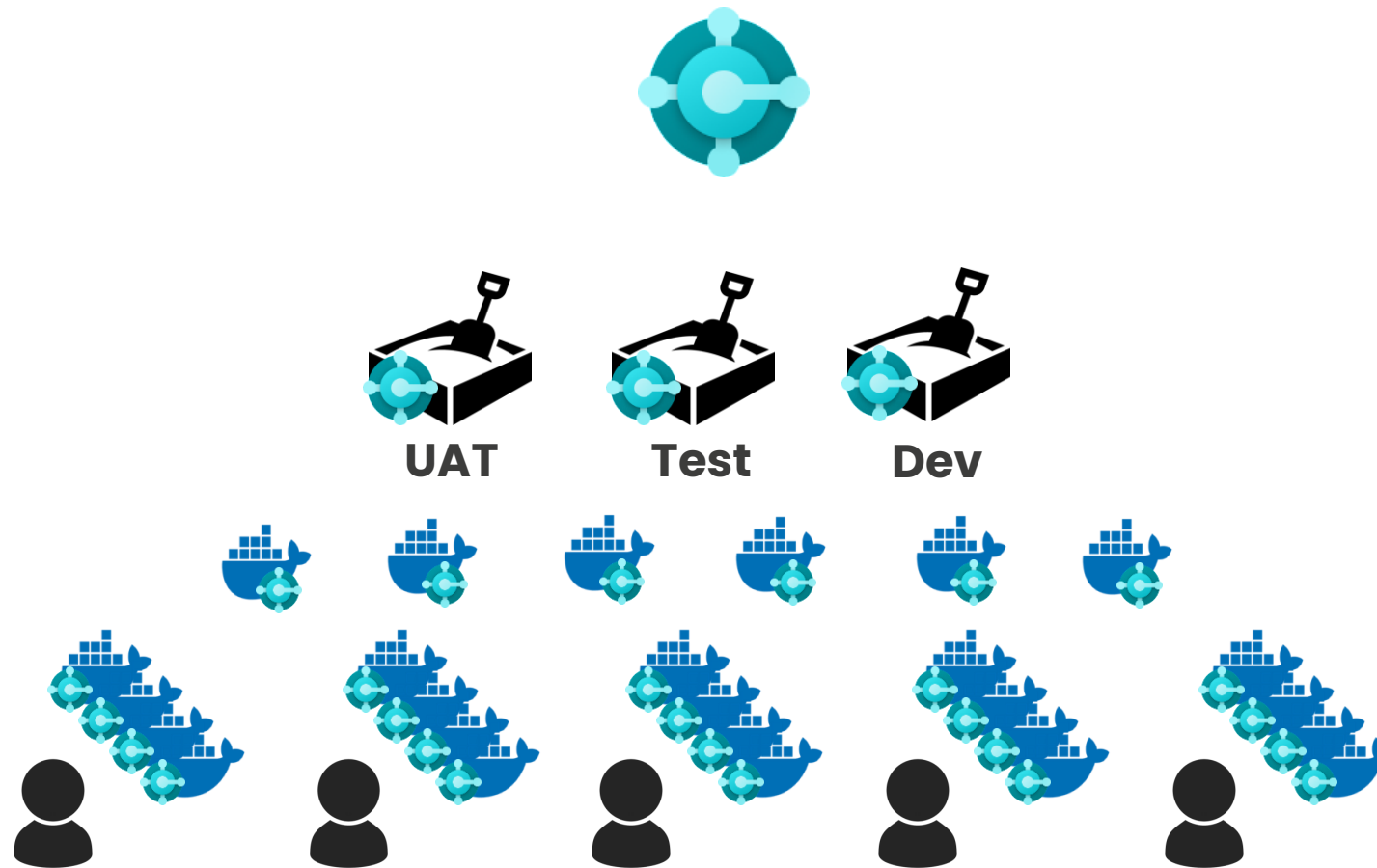


What do we do?

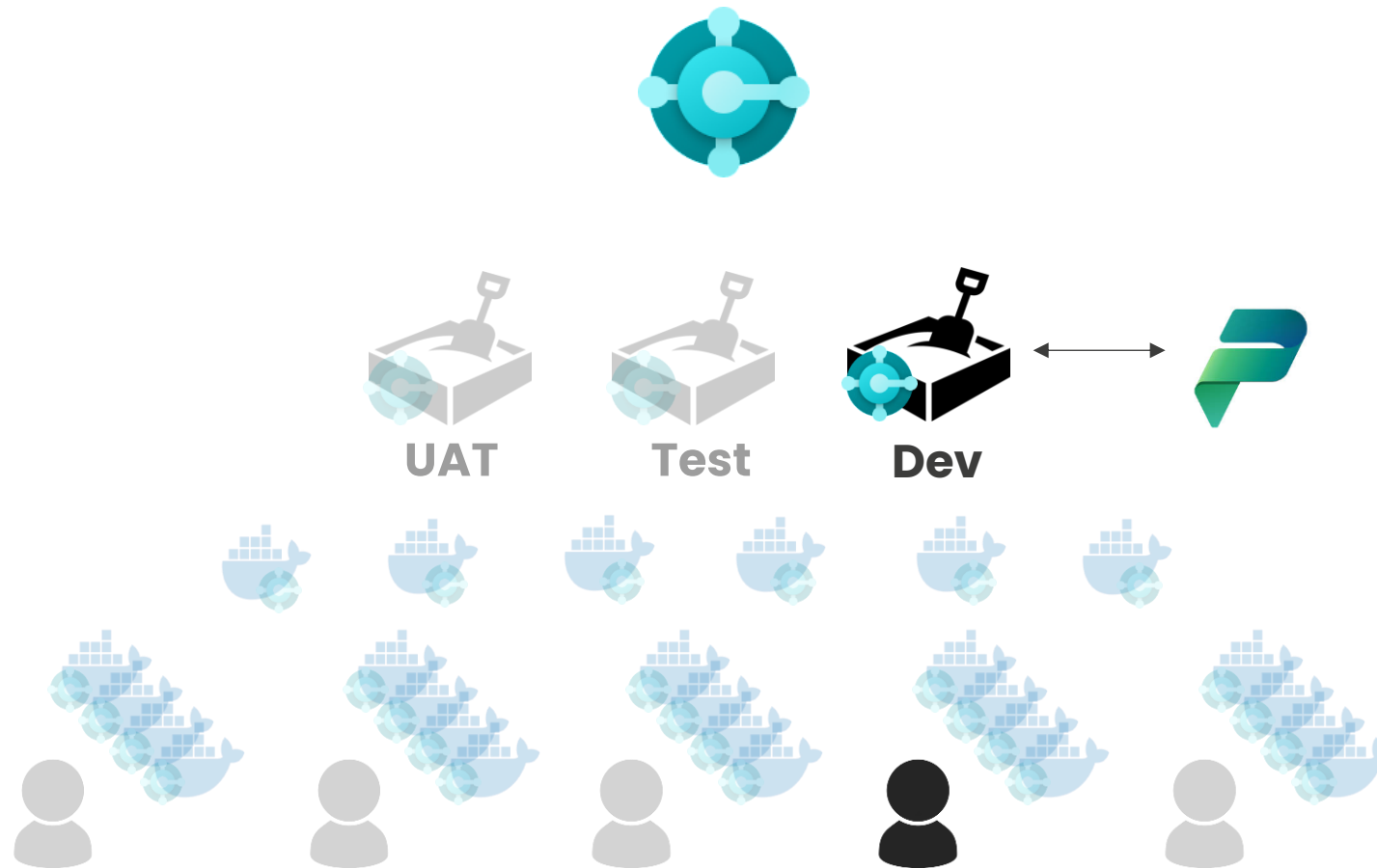
For anything power platform the customers buy a license for any developer who needs to work on it.

It's not a blocker, but you do want to be upfront about it.

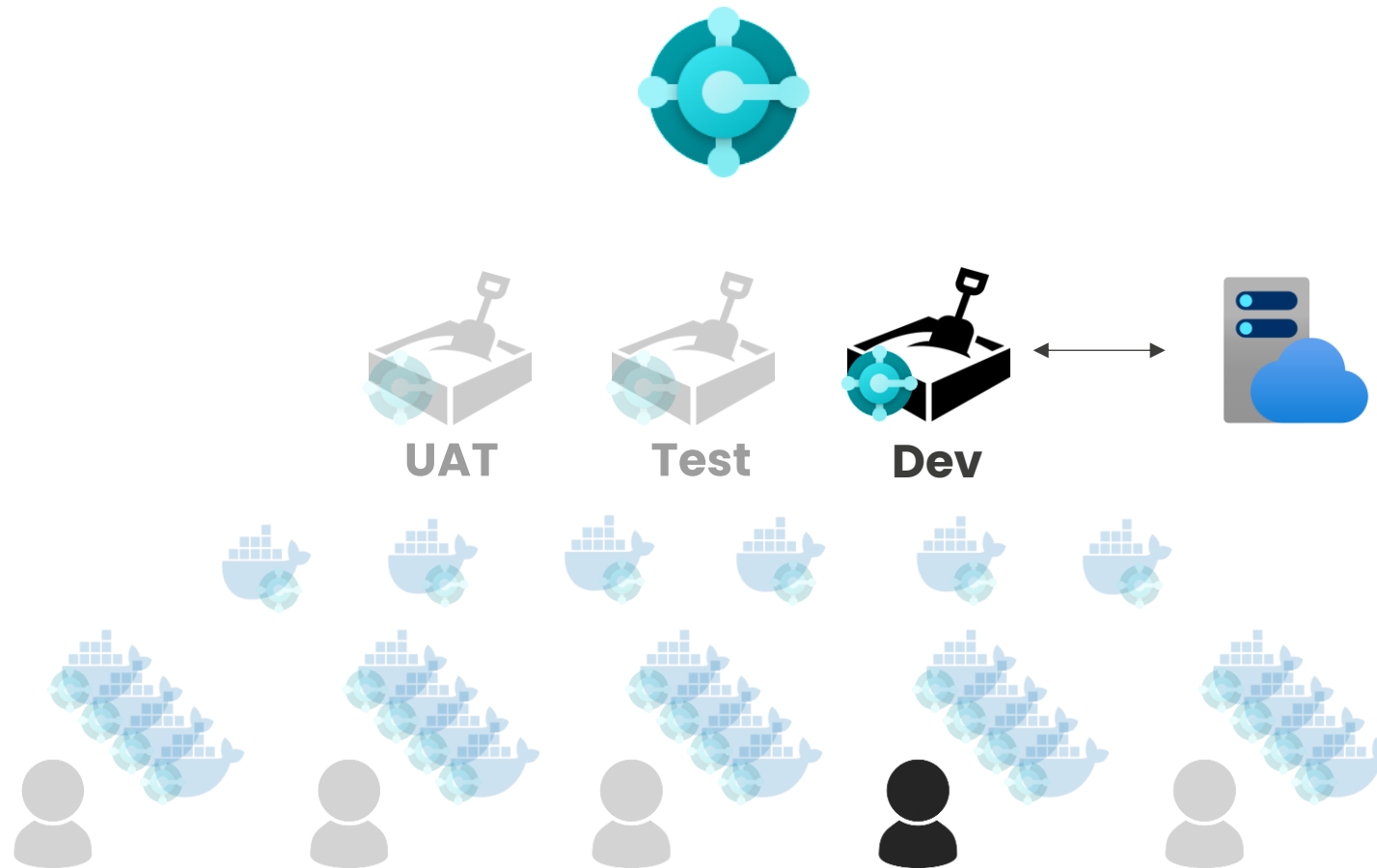
Development Environments



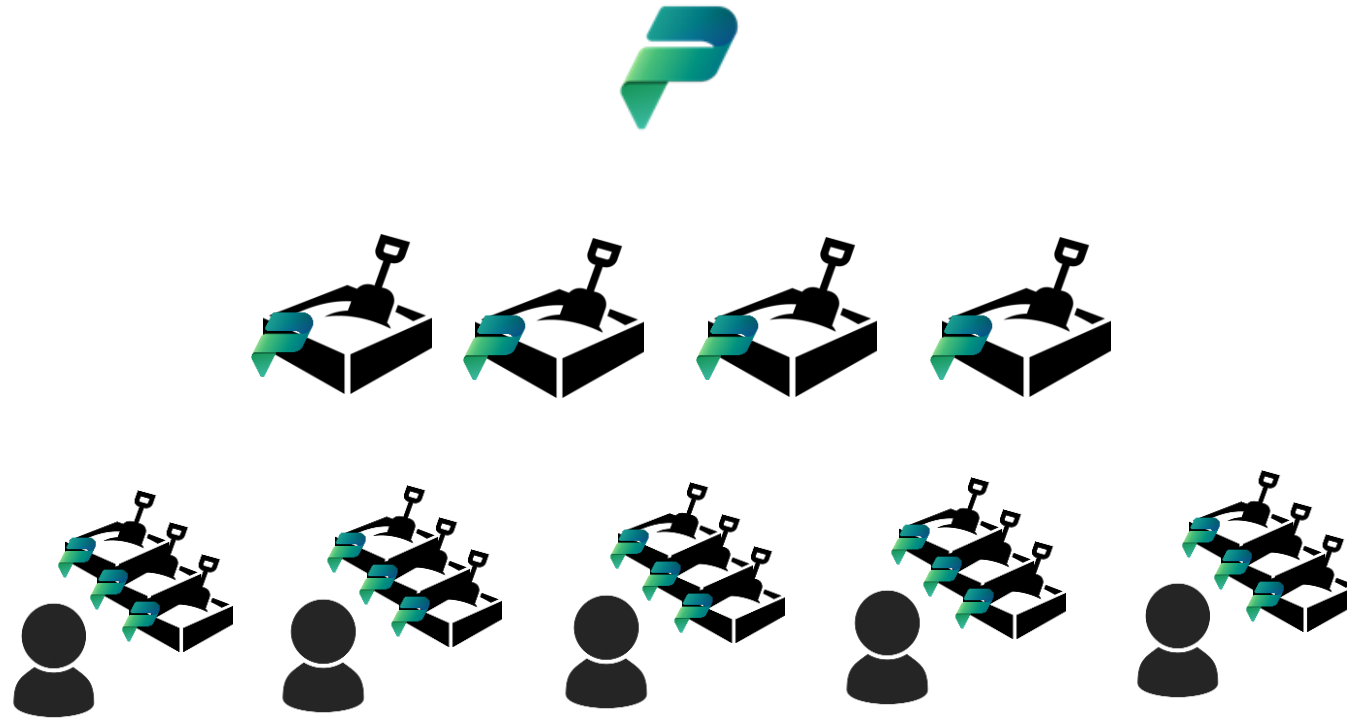
Development Environments



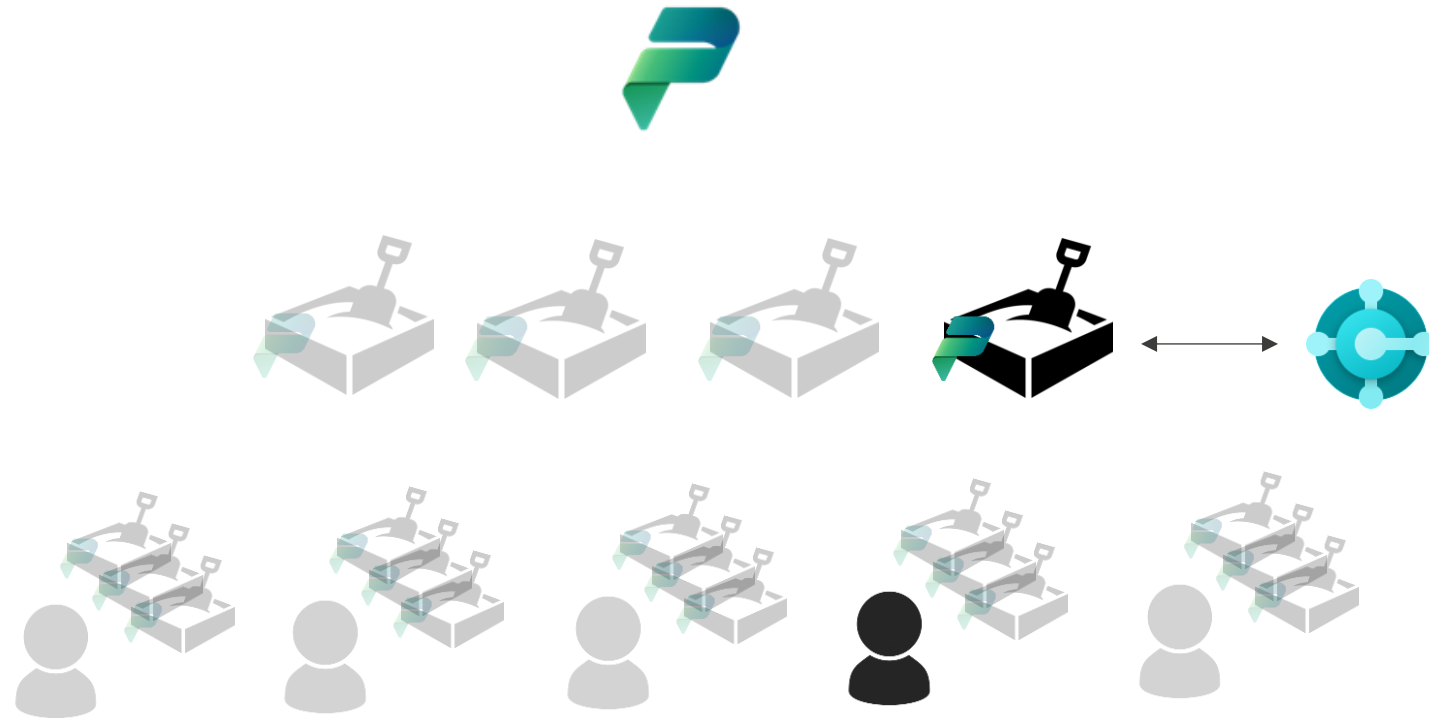
Development Environments



Environments – PP



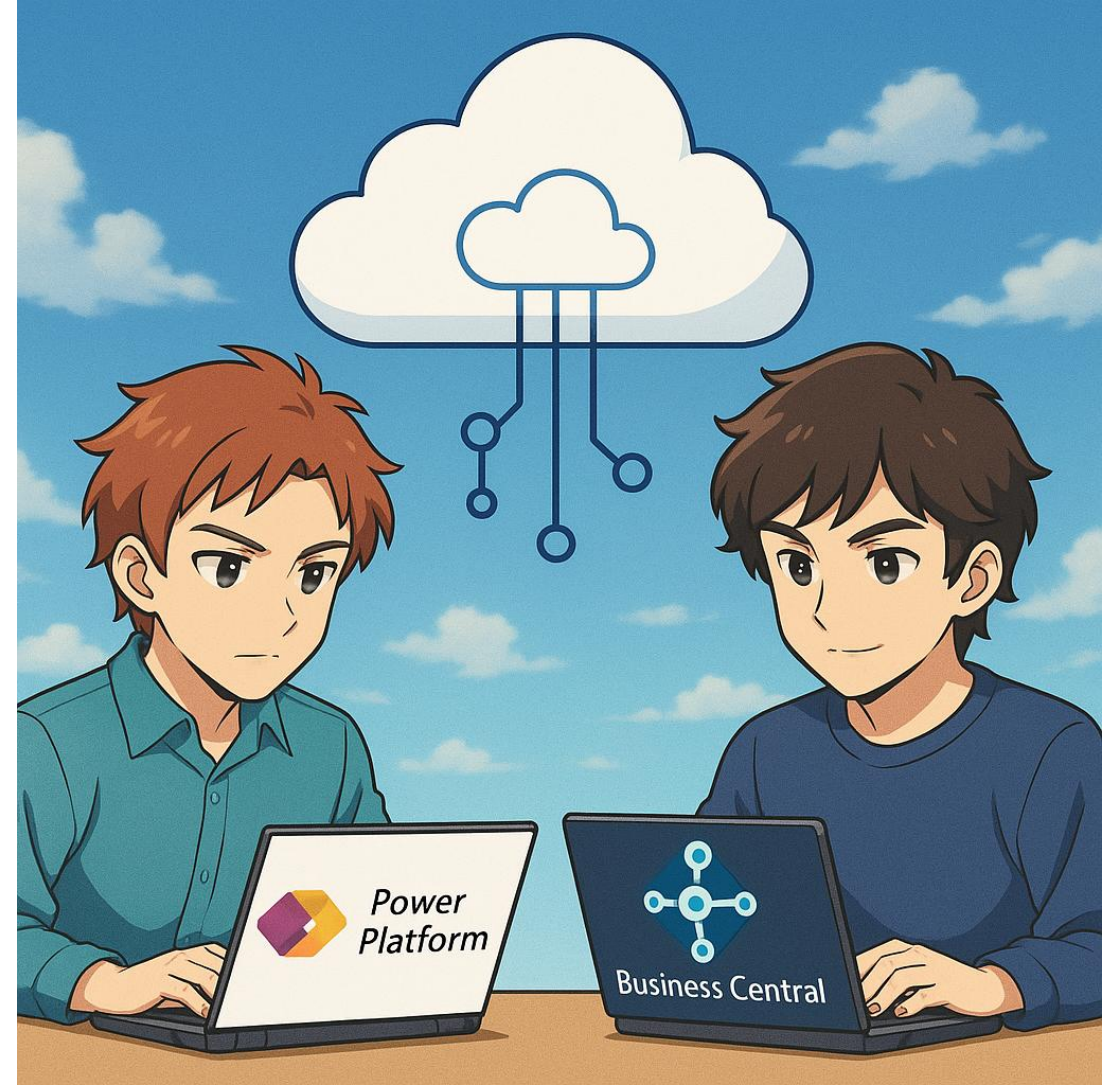
Environments – PP



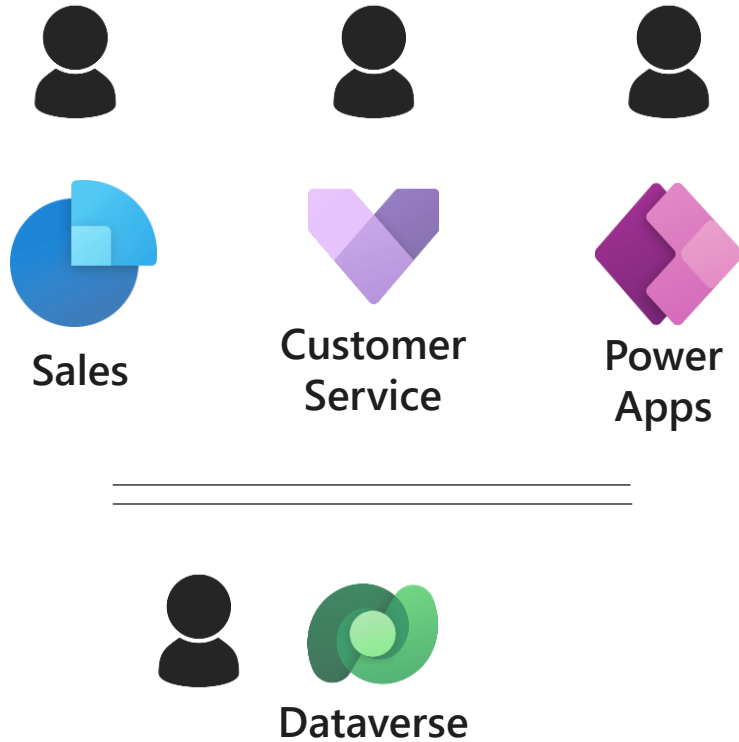
What do we do?

Split development tasks into:

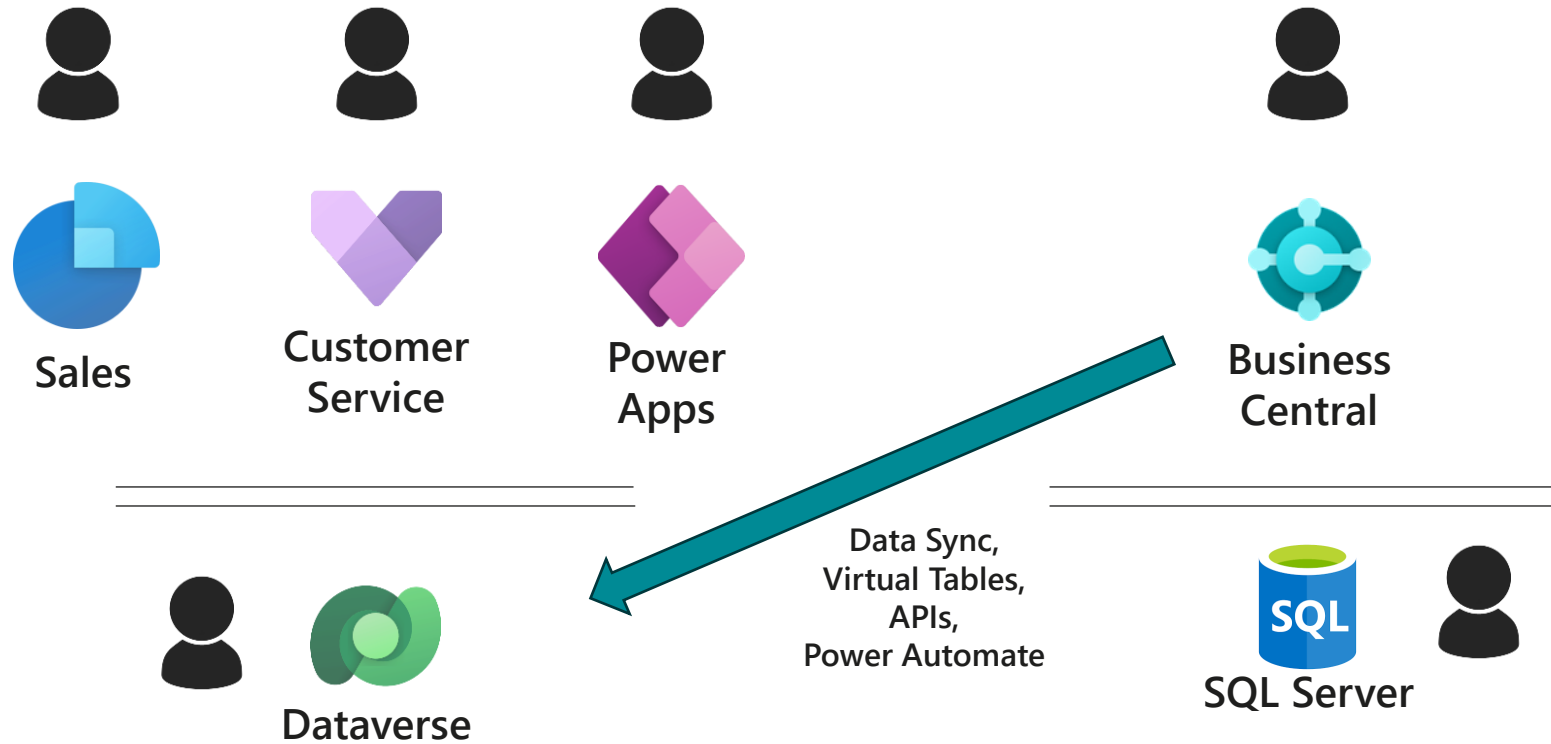
- What needs to be developed together
- What doesn't



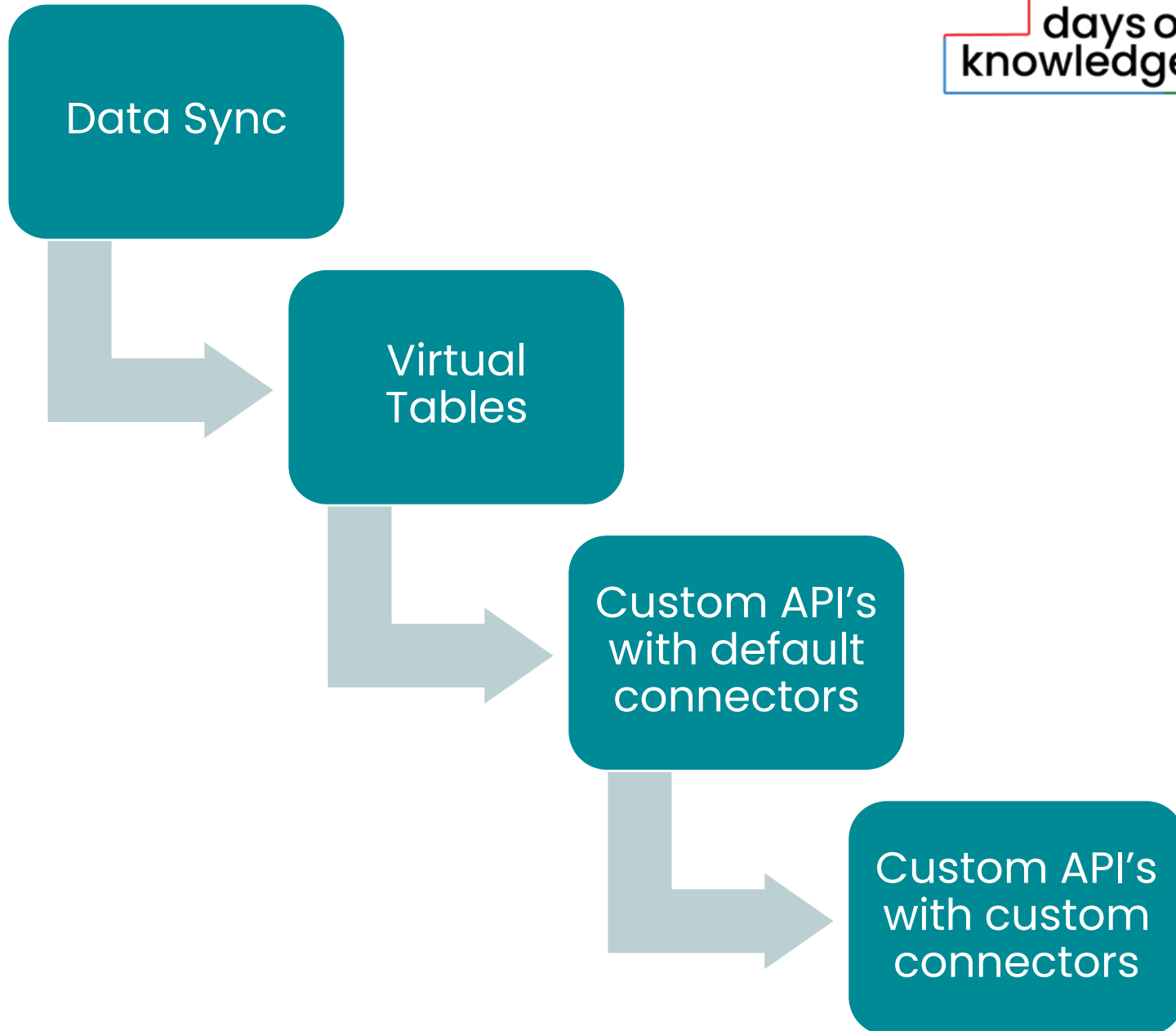
Dataverse



Dataverse



What do we do



Some considerations for Dataverse

Avoid Bidirectional Sync in any way: To prevent conflicts, bidirectional synchronization should generally be avoided

Speed of Synchronization: Data sync speed is 10 minutes, handling up to 1,000 records per 10 minutes.

Synchronous/Asynchronous Processing: encourage async processing: most integrations don't need to be instant.

Where Power Platform really shines...

Power Automate



Triggers are awesome
AL cannot “hook” to webhooks natively



Power
Automate
Logo



Forms Logo

Power Automate

```
5 references
table 50100 "Teams Setup"
{
    Caption = 'Teams Setup' page 50100 "Teams Setup"
    DataClassification = {
        PageType = Card;
        ApplicationArea = All;
        UsageCategory = Administrative;
        SourceTable = "Teams Setup";
        InsertAllowed = false;
        DeleteAllowed = false;
        Caption = 'Teams Setup';
    }
    fields
    {
        2 references
        field(1; "Primary")
        {
            Caption = 'Primary'
            DataClassification = {
                PageType = Card;
                ApplicationArea = All;
                UsageCategory = Administrative;
                SourceTable = "Teams Setup";
                InsertAllowed = false;
                DeleteAllowed = false;
                Caption = 'Teams Setup';
            }
        }
        5 references
        field(2; "Client")
        {
            Caption = 'Client'
            DataClassification = {
                PageType = Card;
                ApplicationArea = All;
                UsageCategory = Administrative;
                SourceTable = "Teams Setup";
                InsertAllowed = false;
                DeleteAllowed = false;
                Caption = 'Teams Setup';
            }
        }
        0 references
        trigger OnValueChanged
        begin
            if xRec.NewRecord
            then
                SetField(Enabled, true);
            end;
        end;
    }
    layout
    {
        area(Content)
        {
            group(General)
            {
                Caption = 'General'
                field(Enabled; "Enabled")
                {
                    ApplicationArea = All;
                    ToolTip = 'Specifies whether the team is enabled.';
                }
            }
            group(Authentication)
            {
                Caption = 'Authentication'
                field(Enabled; "Enabled")
                {
                    ApplicationArea = All;
                    ToolTip = 'Specifies whether the team is enabled.';
                }
            }
        }
    }
}

1 reference | 0% Coverage
local procedure GetAccessToken() Success: Boolean
var
    RequestUrl: Text;
    ResponseText: Text;
    FormContent: Text;
    JsonObject: Text;
    ClientId: Text;
    ClientSecret: Text;
    TenantId: Text;
begin
    if not TeamId
    then
        Error('TeamId is required');
    end;
    // Get credentials
    ClientId := TeamsS
    ClientSecret := TeamId
    TenantId := Channel

    if (ClientId = '' or ClientSecret = '' or TenantId = '')
    then
        Error('Invalid credentials');
    end;
    RequestUrl := 'https://login.microsoftonline.com/' + TenantId + '/oauth2-2.0/token?client_id=' + ClientId + '&grant_type=client_credentials';
    ResponseText := GetHttpContent(RequestUrl, 'POST', '');
    if ResponseText = ''
    then
        Error('Failed to get access token');
    end;
    JsonObject := ParseJson(ResponseText);
    ClientId := JsonObject['access_token'];
end;

2 references | 0% Coverage
procedure SendChannelMessage(ChannelId: Integer; Message: Text)
var
    RequestBody: Text;
begin
    ResponseText := SendRequest('https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/channels/' + ChannelId + '/messages', 'POST', RequestBody);
end;

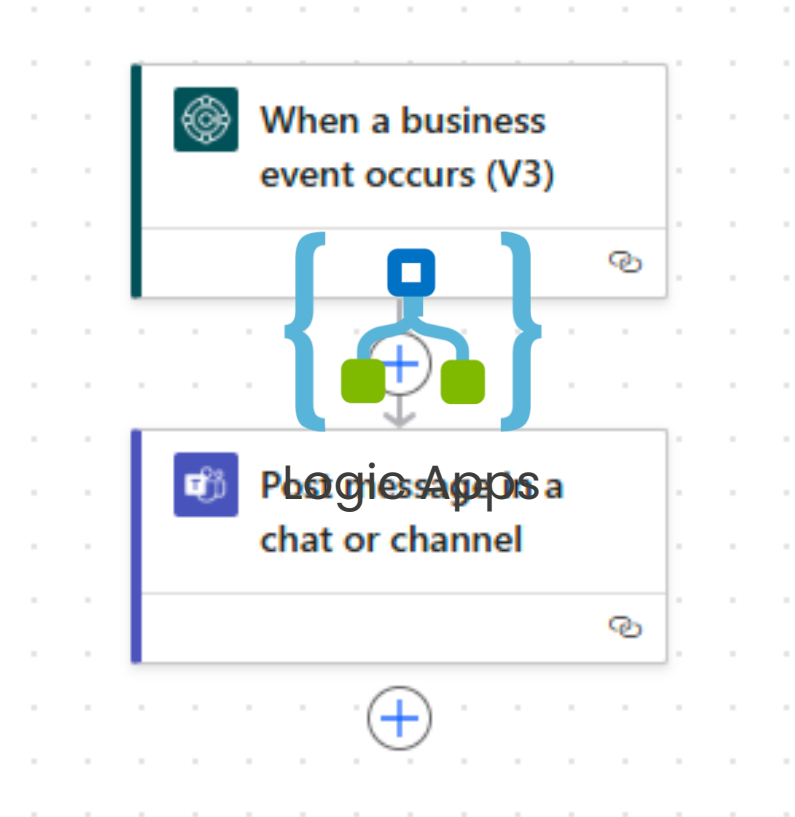
3 references | 0% Coverage
local procedure SendRequest(Url: Text; Method: Text; Body: Text)
var
    ResponseText: Text;
begin
    // Create request
    HttpRequest.Method := Method;
    HttpRequest.SetRequestUri(Url);
    HttpRequest.GetHeaders(HttpHeaders);
    // Set headers
    HttpHeaders.Remove('Content-Type');
    HttpHeaders.Remove('Accept');
    HttpHeaders.Add('Content-Type', ContentTypeJson);
    HttpHeaders.Add('Accept', AcceptJson);
    HttpHeaders.Remove('Authorization');
    HttpHeaders.Add('Authorization', StrSubstNo('Bearer %1', ClientId));
    // Set body if provided
    if Body <> ''
    then
        HttpRequest.Body := Body;
    end;
    ResponseText := SendHttp(HttpRequest);
end;
```

Power Automate

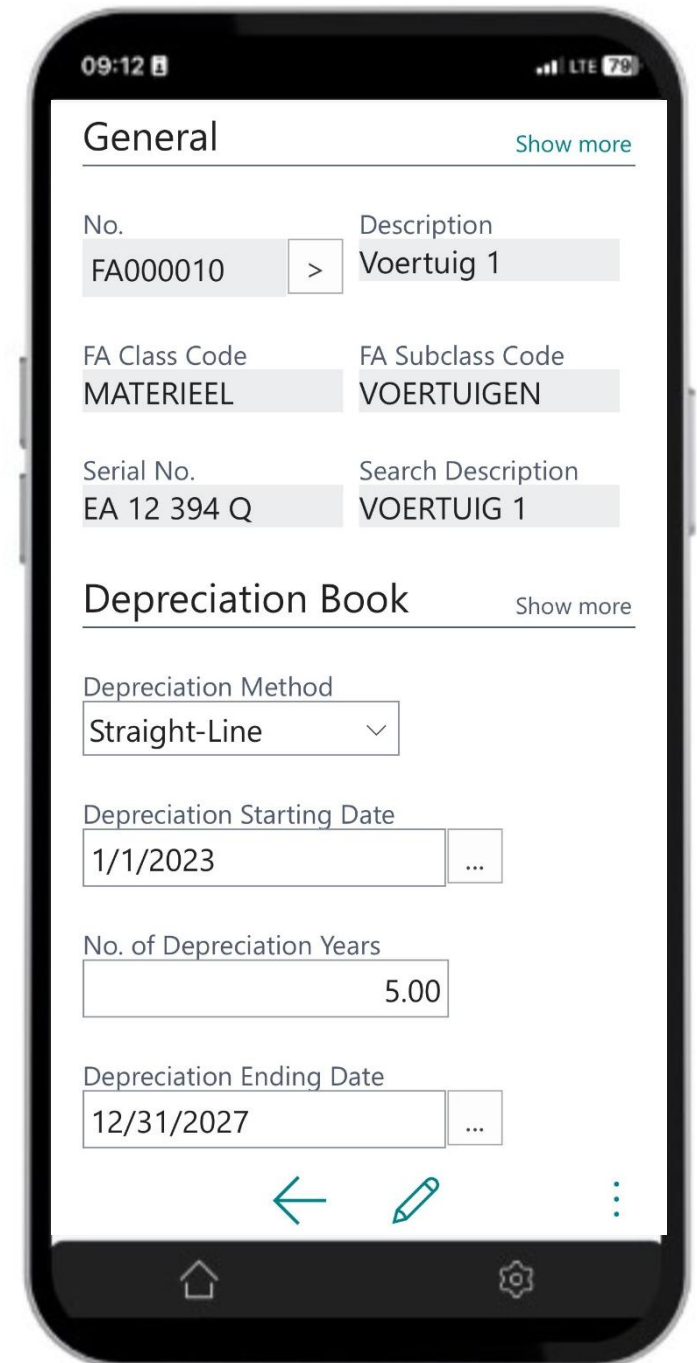
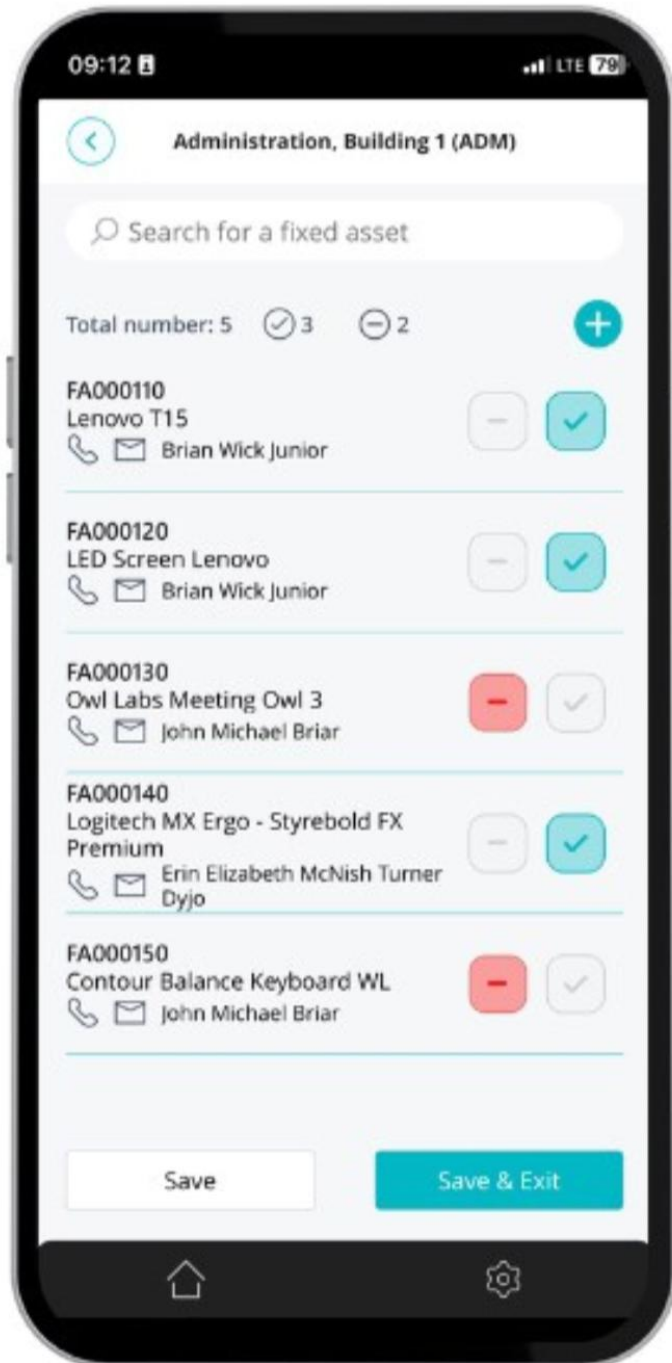
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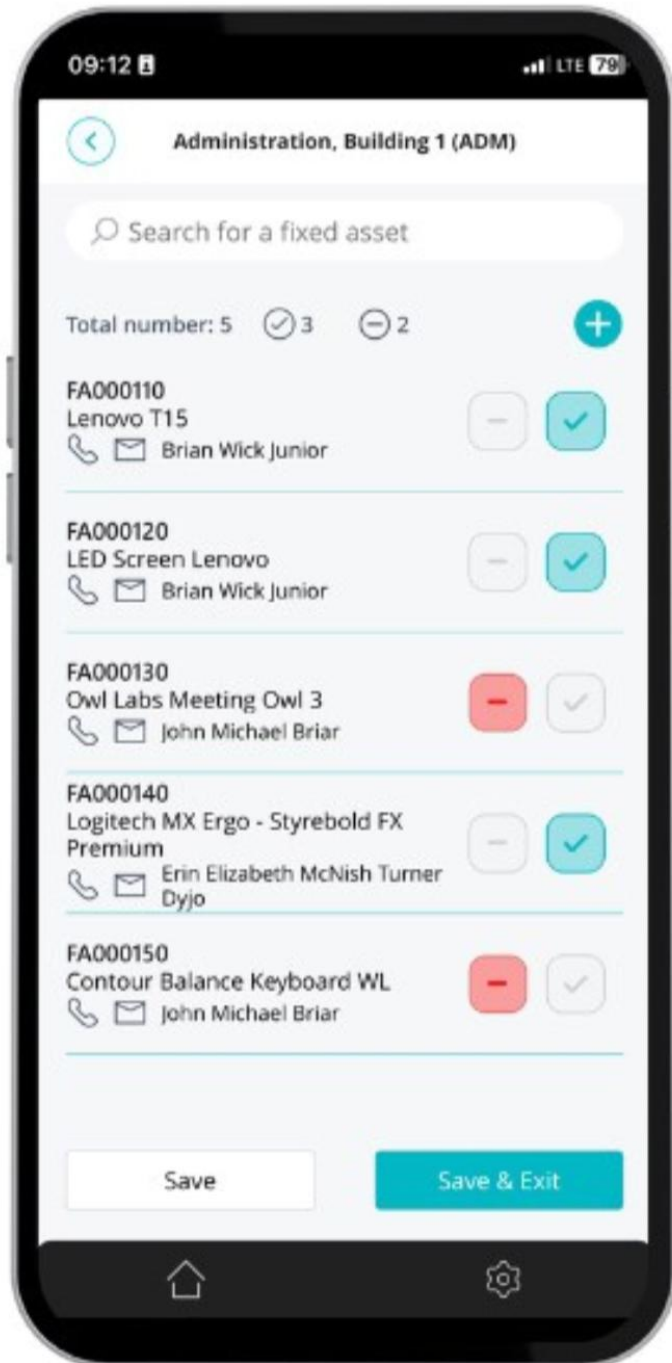
Simplify non-critical integrations

It's Power Automate not Power Integrate 🤨

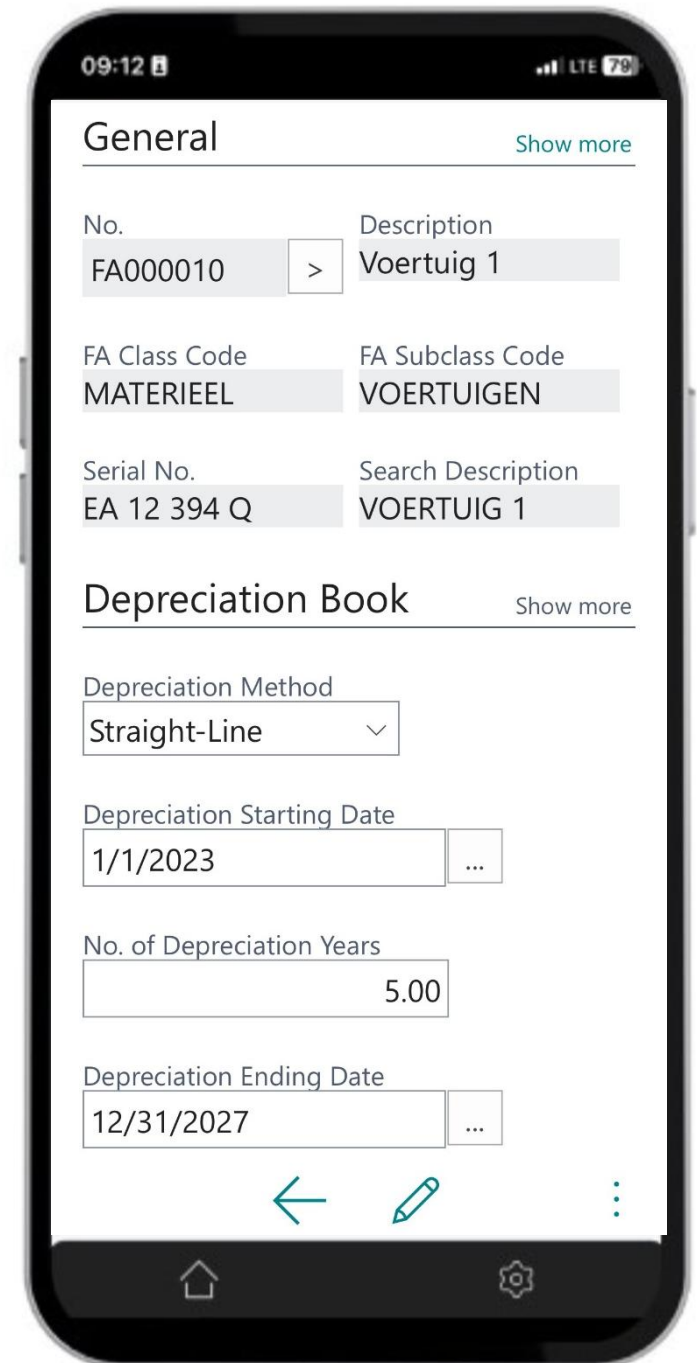
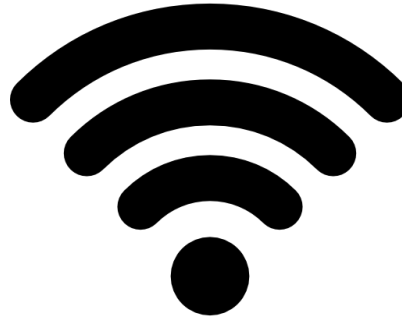


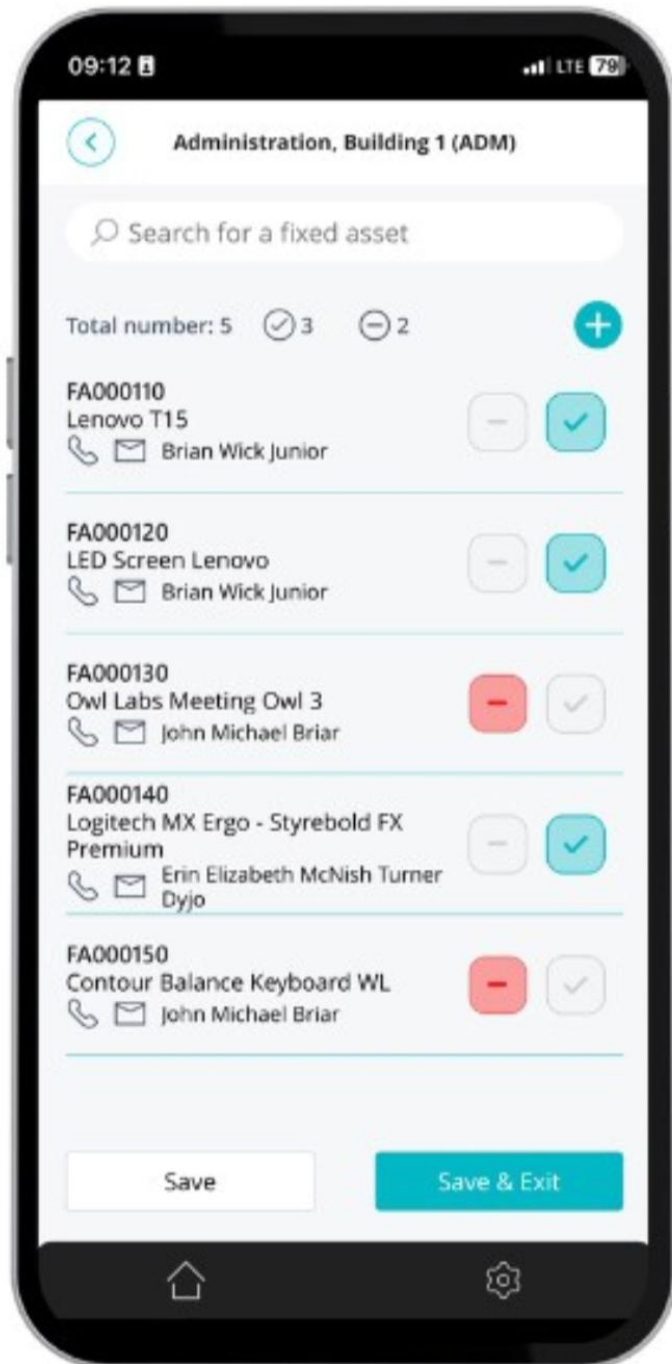
Simplistic UI



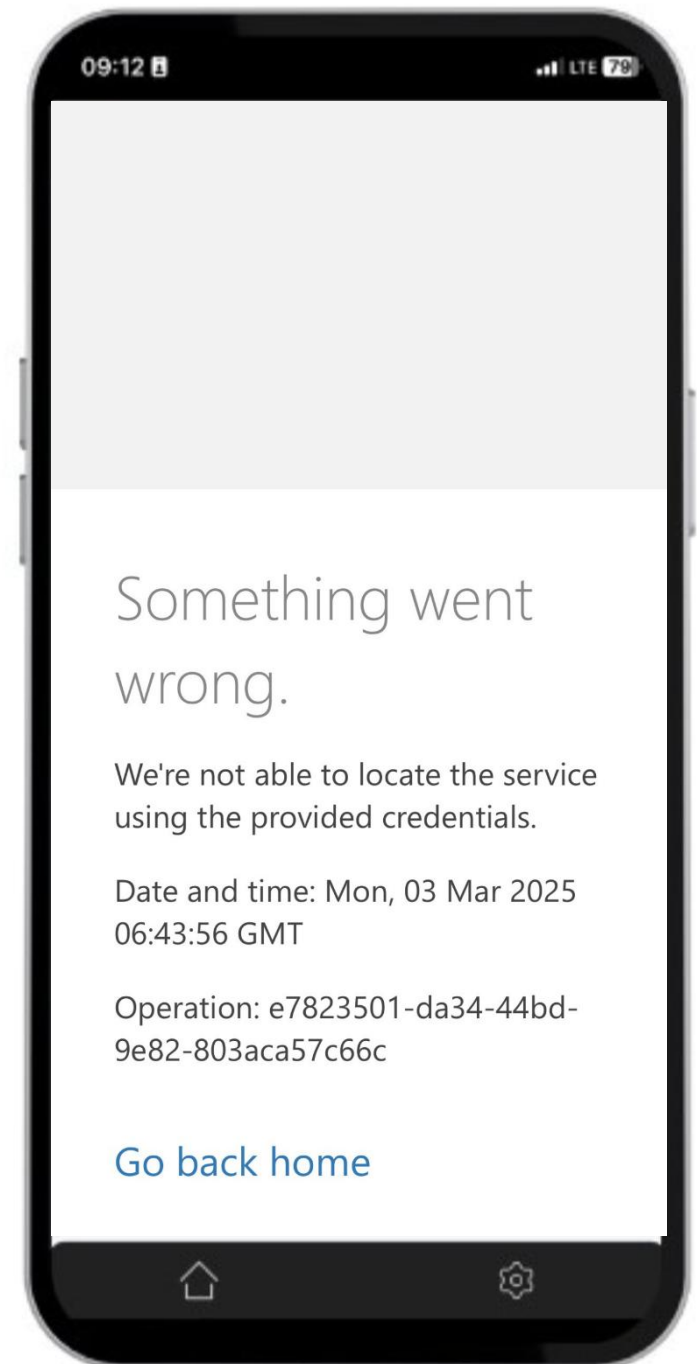


Offline Mode





Offline Mode









Power Pages

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Item Catalog

See a list of all our wonderful items that will make your offices shine in a completely new light!

Product ID ↑	Name	Description	Quantity On Hand	List Price
1896-S	ATHENS Desk		4.00	USD649.40
1900-S	PARIS Guest Chair, black		0.00	USD125.10
1906-S	ATHENS Mobile Pedestal		5.00	USD281.40
1908-S	LONDON Swivel Chair, blue		3.00	USD123.30
1920-S	ANTWERP Conference Table		10.00	USD420.40
1925-W	Conference Bundle 1-6		0.00	USD122.50
1928-S	AMSTERDAM Table		8.00	USD35.60



ATHENS Desk

The only option for truly sky-rocketing your productivity. The perfect addition to your home office.



PARIS Guest Chair

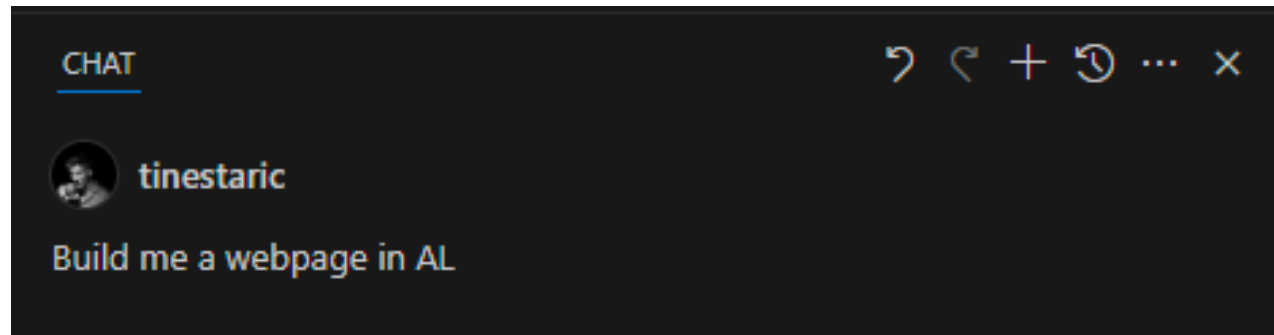
Seating experience reimagined. You will never want to get up ever again.



ATHENS Mobile Pedestal

The perfect addition to any balcony. Give the people an option to put that perfect cup of coffee down for a second and enjoy the morning air.

Power Pages



Power Pages

CHAT

tinestarc

Build me a webpage in AL

GitHub Copilot

I can't create a webpage in AL (Application Language) since AL is used for developing extensions for Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central, not for building webpages.

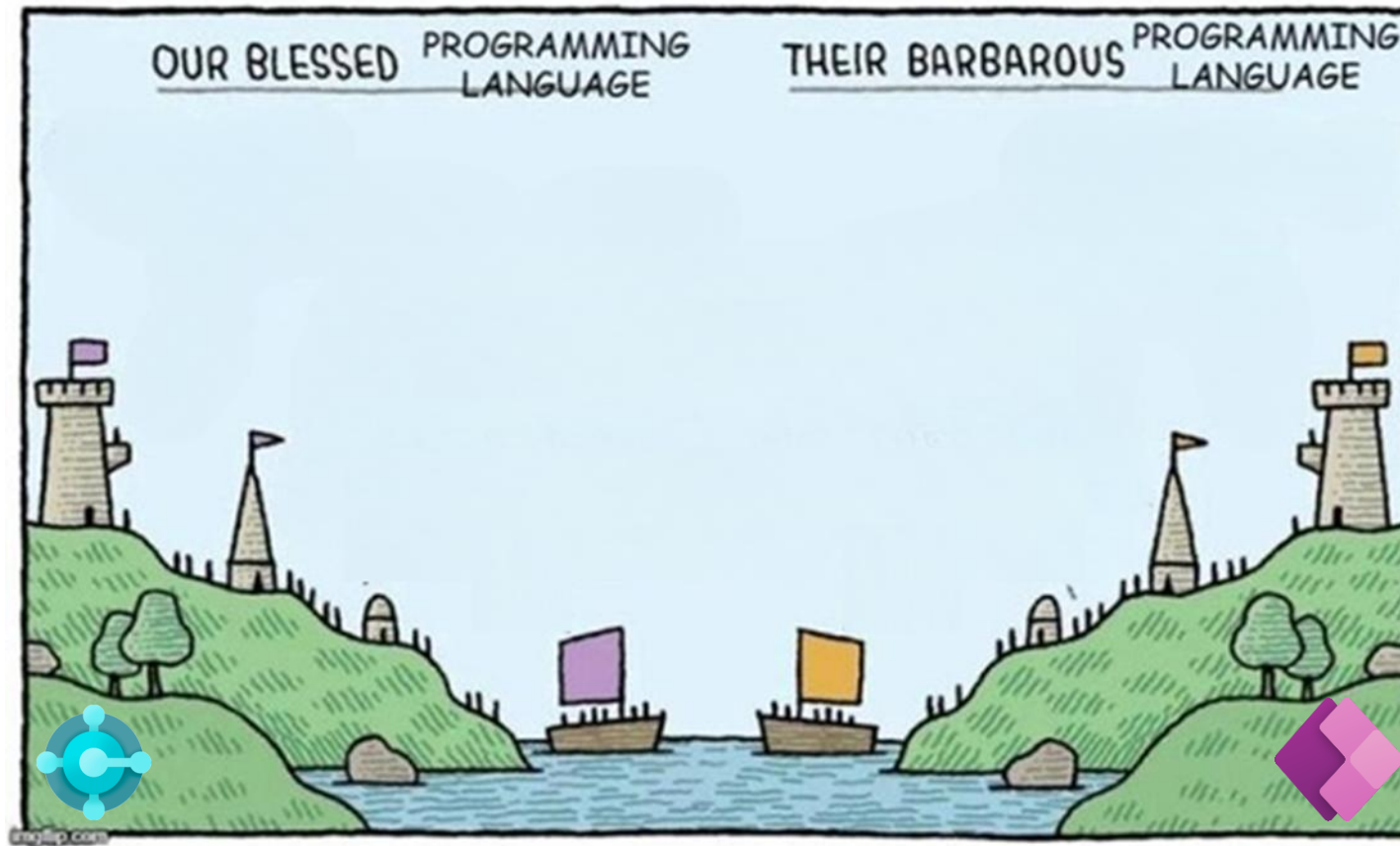
If you're looking to create a webpage, you would typically use HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Would you like me to help you build a webpage using these web technologies instead?

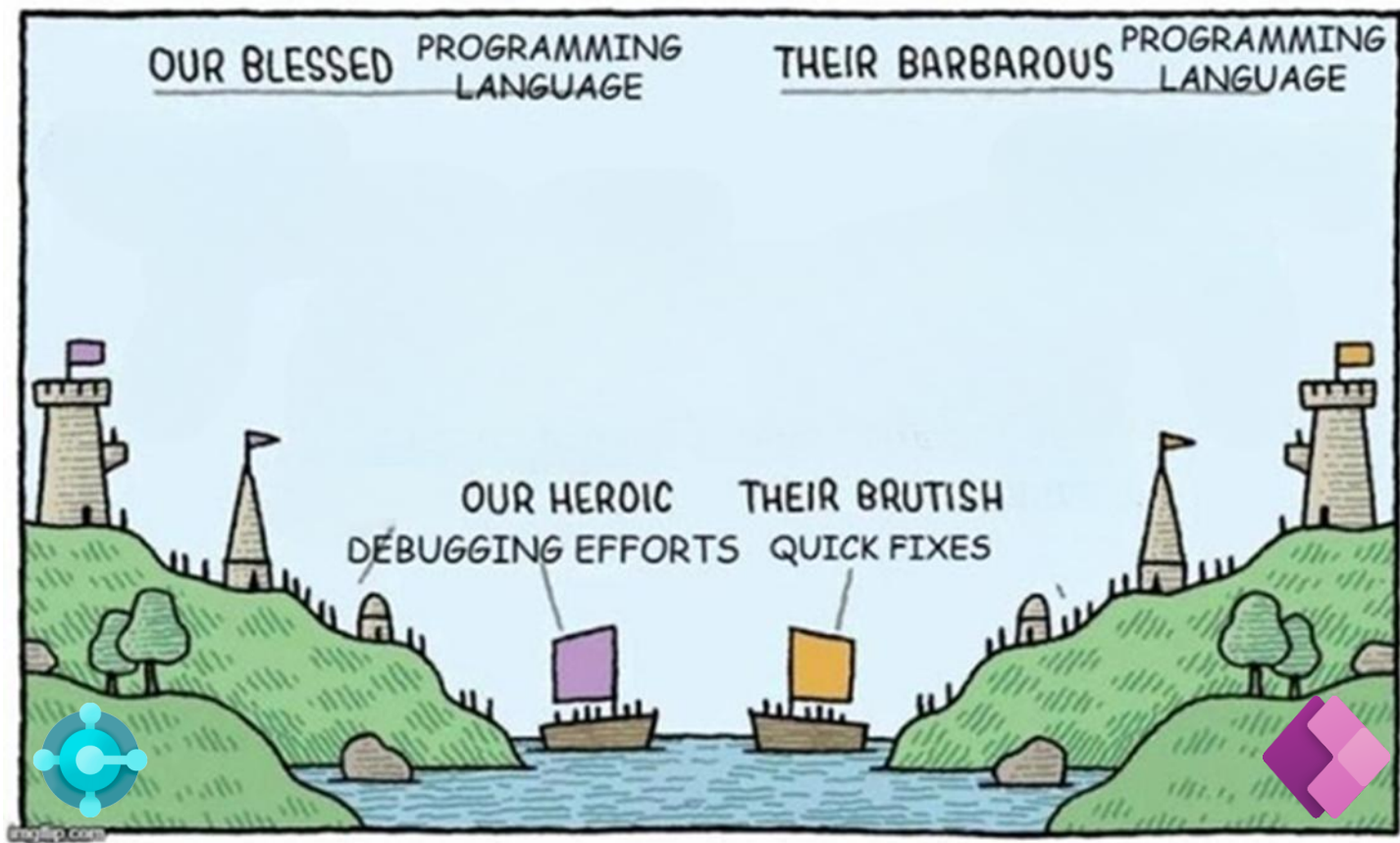
Data collection is key

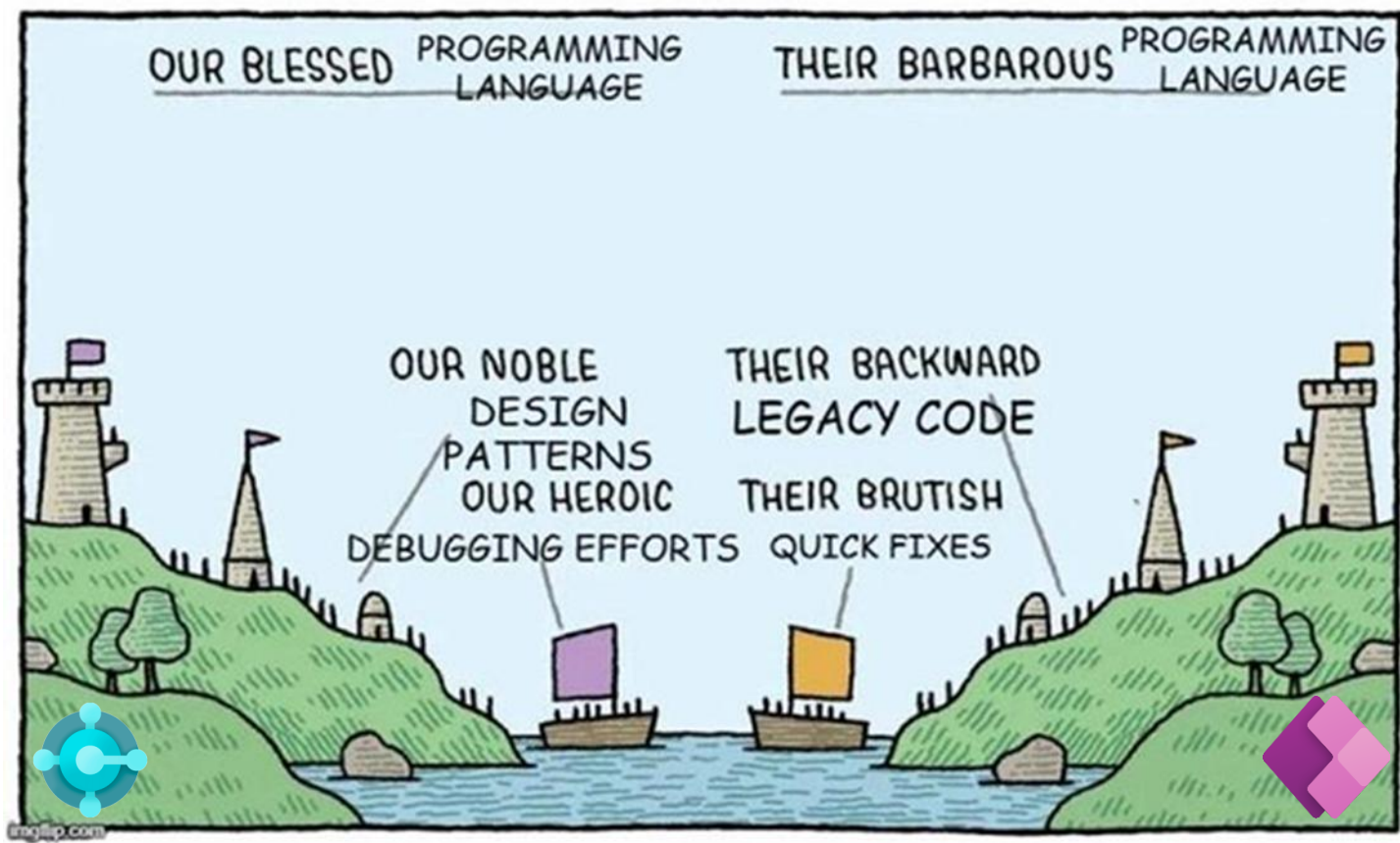
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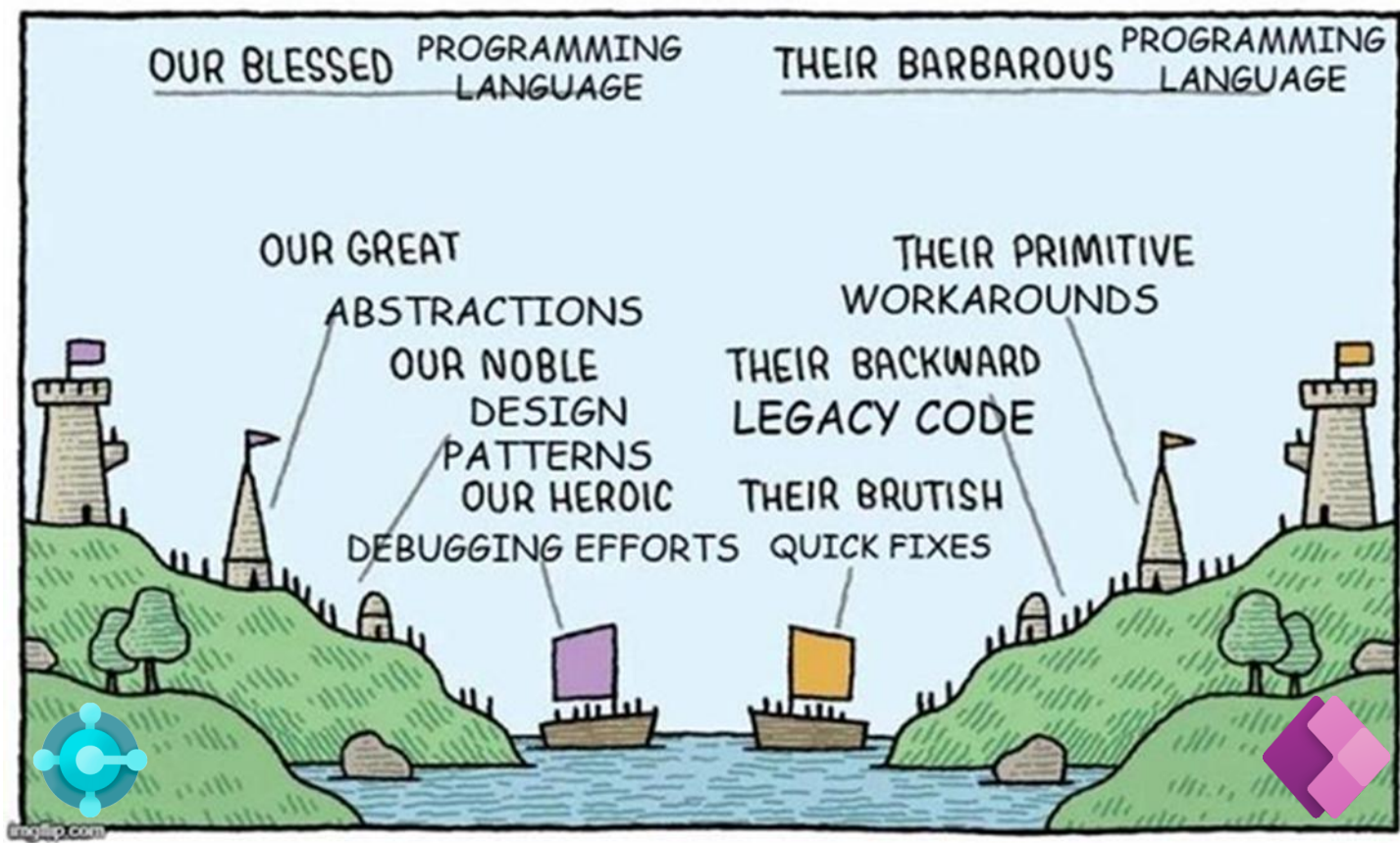


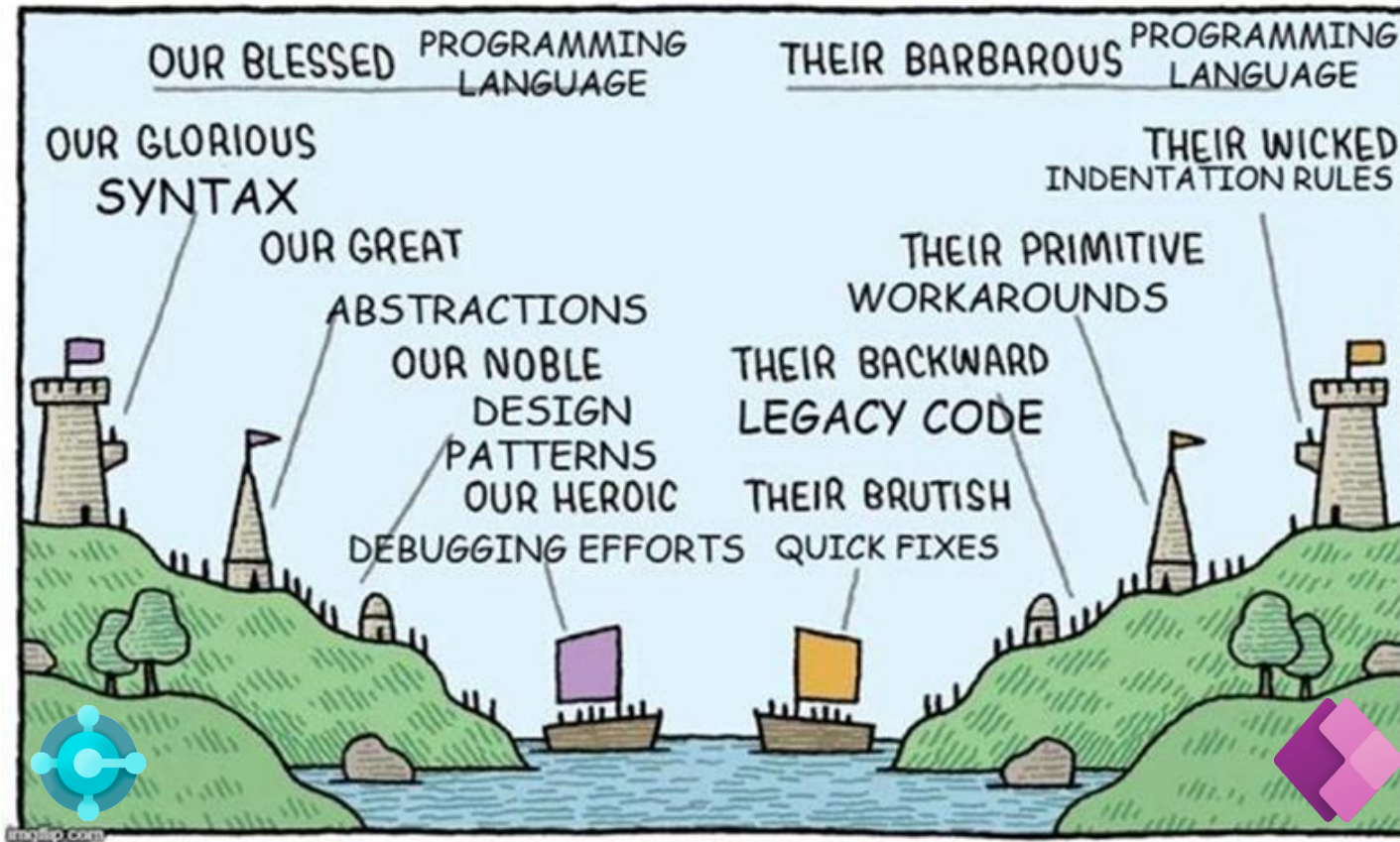
Key takeaways

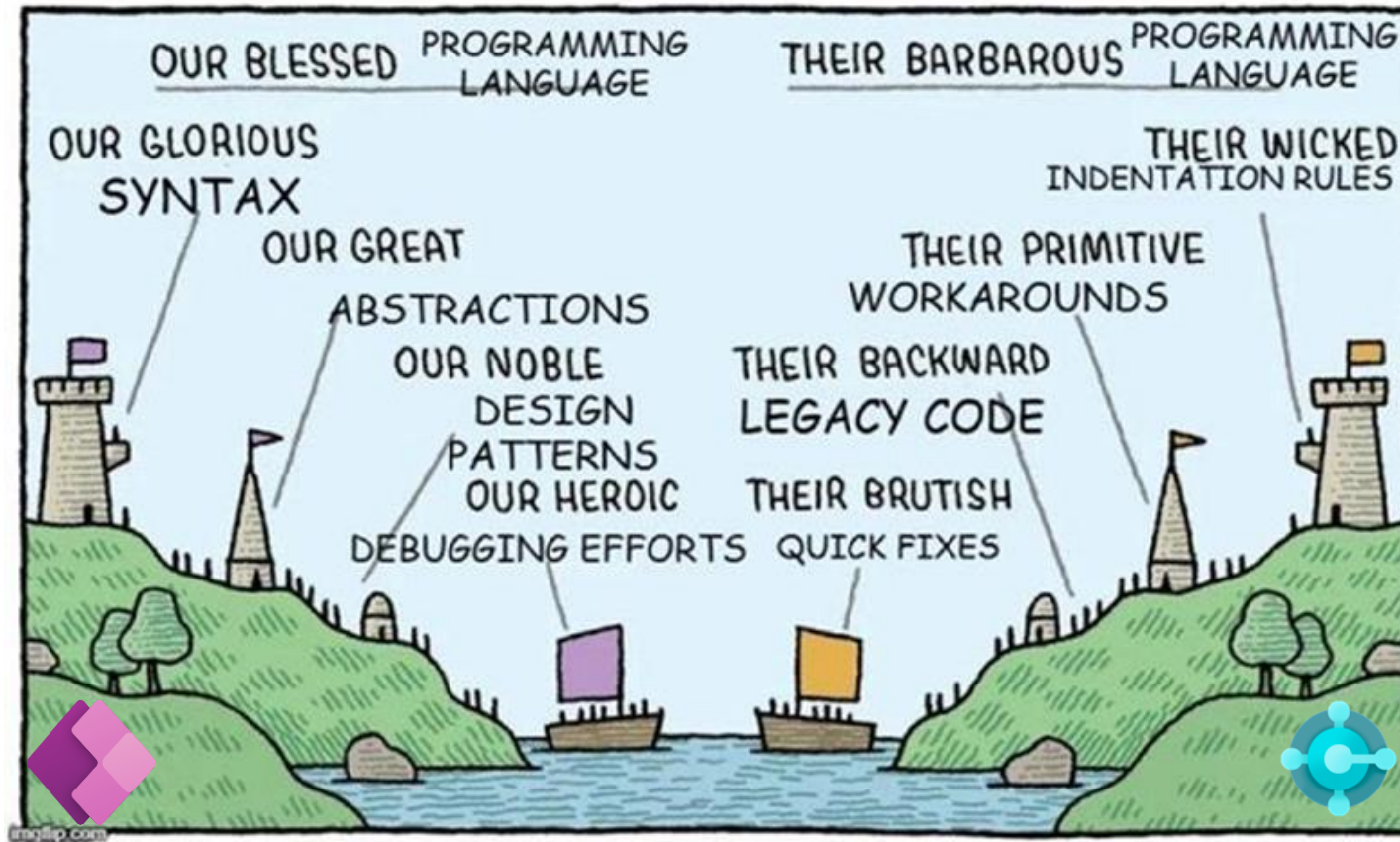












Bringing Power Platform and BC together?

*Bringing Power Platform and BC together? Plan it, pipeline it,
or prepare for pain.*

You don't "*just do Power Platform*" without making a mess

You don't "*just do Business Central*" without making a mess

Data collection is key

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Give us Feedback!

Find me on:

- X & Bsky: @TineStaric
- LinkedIn: /timestaric
- Blog: tine.staric.net
- Email: tine.staric@companial.com

Reach out with questions!

Thank you !

